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Piedmont Post

A Community Newspaper Serving the Citizens of Piedmont

Candidates' Q & A – City Council Week 8

By Jake Lannon

Each election cycle, the *Piedmont Post* provides extensive coverage of each candidate to help residents make informed voting decisions.

For this year's race, the *Post* will send one question per week to the candidates running for City Council until Election Day. The five City Council candidates vying for three open seats received the question on Tuesday, October 13, and were asked to reply in 200 words.

Week 8 question:

In August, Police Chief Shavies gave a presentation to the City Council on the issues he's seeing with e-bikes in the community. He was concerned about the lack of education around purchasing e-bikes and, in turn, the increased injury risk to younger riders if they've purchased an e-bike far more powerful than expected. What is your personal experience with e-bikes and your perspective on whether the city should regulate e-bikes in addition to what the state does?

Adam Hundt
(http://adamhundt.com/)

Certainly, Piedmont must prioritize resident and rider safety. As e-bikes are more widely adopted, hospitals are noting an increase in injuries due to these devices. I believe a first step to ensure safe e-bike riding in Piedmont is to educate residents on this issue. If warranted by data from the Piedmont Police Department, it is reasonable to explore creating a local ordinance regarding e-bikes.

Currently, there is a lack of awareness about California rules regarding e-bikes. Certain bikes are in fact, electric motorcycles capable of speeds over 20 mph and should not be used by teenagers unless they have a motorcycle license. Riders under age 18 must use a helmet on an e-bike. E-bikes must have proper lighting or a reflector.

I agree with Police Chief Shavies, who said in an August 2026 presentation to Piedmont City Council, "Our goal is education before enforcement." City government can work with Piedmont Police to provide education through Piedmont schools, parent groups, and community events, while also gathering data on e-bike incidents in the city. As needed, Piedmont could explore steps such as the ordinance passed in Danville, which requires e-bike riders to walk devices in park spaces and limits speeds on trails.

Tom Ramsey
Incumbent
(http://vote4tomramsey.com/)

I ride an e-bike on occasion as part of my commute. I hop on my Gazelle, ride to Jack London

See Candidates' Q&A on page 27



Kindergartener Leia lends a helping hand at the Wildwood Dads Club Pumpkin Patch.

Giant Jack guesses open until Oct. 27

By Jay Russell

The Wildwood Dads Club (WWDC) Pumpkin Patch has enjoyed a busy October, ringing up more than 4,000 items while offering families 30 varieties of pumpkins, squash, and gourds. Among the favorites are the tiny Wee-B-Little pumpkins, with 442 sold so far.

This year's heavyweight contender, Giant Jack, has also garnered plenty of attention, with 190 entries in the Guess the Weight contest, with guesses ranging from 100 pounds to 5,100 pounds.

"Jack kept us waiting this year,

See Pumpkin Patch on page 28



Who will guess Giant Jack's weight?

FAQ - Secondary Math Pathways

By Ariel Dolowich,
PUSD Assistant Superintendent

Piedmont Unified School District (PUSD) would like to clarify information regarding the article titled, "Changes to Math Pathways accelerate all 6th graders" in the Piedmont Post on Oct. 14th. Thank you for allowing me the opportunity to provide accurate details on the developments that have taken place. Please note that additional updates will also be provided in PUSD's next Piedmont Pulse.

***Q:** What problem are we solving? Why now?*

A: Typically, school districts prioritize and adopt new curriculum on a seven-year cycle. Secondary math curriculum was last adopted in PUSD in the 2016-17 school year and lives in the district's LCAP as a priority item this year.

Clear limitations have surfaced with respect to PUSD's current curriculum, CPM, and our current math pathway. At the middle school level, the current pathway options are grade-level or compression. Students select a path before entering middle school and do not have the option of changing paths until they reach high school. This does not effectively meet the needs of all students and limits opportunities for

See Math Pathways on page 7

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Mayor Andersen reflects on her time in public office

By Jake Lannon

This December Piedmont Mayor Betsy Smegal Andersen will leave office after serving for nine years on Piedmont's City Council. On Thursday, October 15, at the State of the City address, Andersen reflected on her time as mayor and shared a few key lessons she learned.

The address was held at Piedmont's Community Hall, where city employees, council members, first responders, and community members gathered to hear the mayor speak. The event began with an opening video showcasing the city's achievements throughout the year. Longtime Piedmont resident Eric Havian, who led the Piedmont Recreational Facilities Organization that helped raise $2.1 million for the Community Pool, introduced the mayor with a short speech.



Mayor Betsy Smegal Andersen begins her State of the City address.

Mayor Andersen's family was in the front row as she reminisced about growing up in Piedmont and raising her children here. Before running for City Council, Andersen was a part of the Public Safety Committee and Recreation Commission, focusing on capital improvements and building a new pool. In 2018, Andersen ran for City Council and was re-elected in 2022, serving a full two terms.

"Serving the community where I grew up has been an

See Mayor Andersen on page 23

Opinion



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Collecting photos for Where in the World

For 28 years, Piedmont residents have made sure their travels are well documented, with photos of family members reading the *Piedmont Post* in far-off places throughout the world, and some nearby.

The *Post* invites families to send photos with the *Post* from near and far for publication in *Where in the World Are We* on the back page of the paper. With people able to travel once again, there is no better time to have your photo in the *Post.*

Send photos as .jpg files to: news@piedmont-post.com, and be sure to include a brief description of the location where the photo was taken.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Quote of the Week

"A good newspaper is a nation talking to itself."

– Arthur Miller
1915-2005
American playwright

Opinion

Math detracking at PMS?

By Richie Przybyla

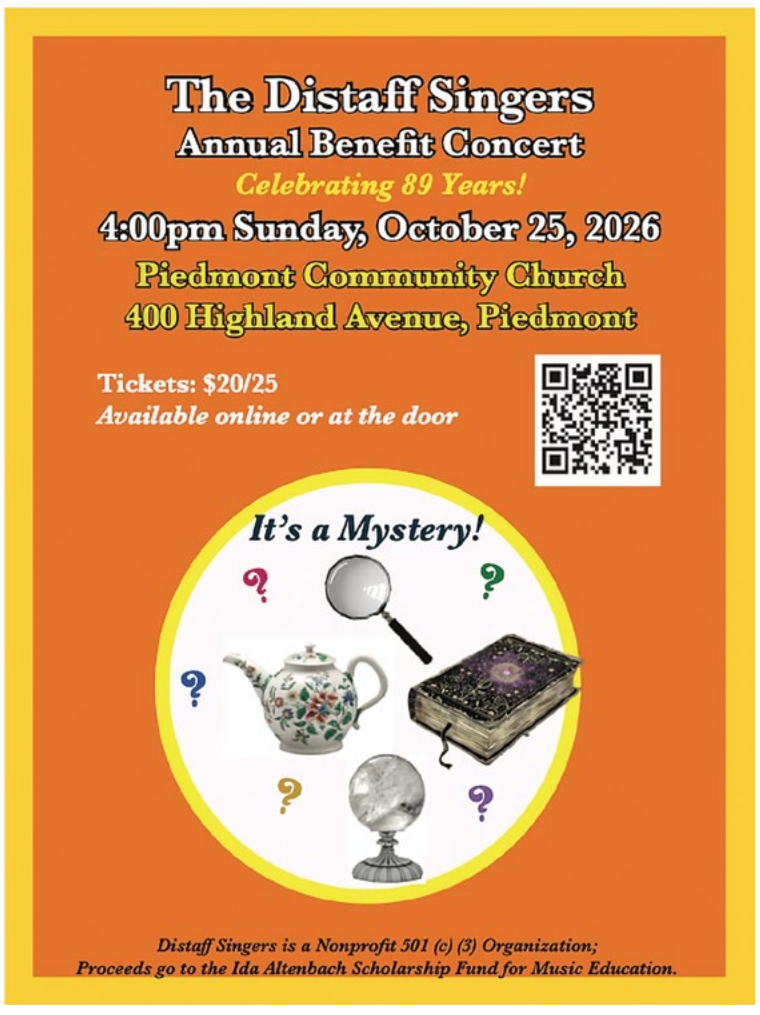
Editor:

I want to thank the Board of Education for their service and for adoption of the new AGA math curriculum. However, I'm writing to express my frustration with the Board's adoption of the new Math "Don't-call-it-compression-for-all" Pathways despite the impassioned testimony from the PMS and PHS math teachers, who spent nearly four hours Wednesday evening at the Board meeting in protest of the new policy and the process by which it was arrived at.

The Board is rightfully concerned about the roughly 30% of PMS students who perform below state math standards. Ariel Dolowich presented clear data showing that the majority of these students are in the grade-level track, which essentially only demonstrates that district staff is categorizing the performance of the children correctly. Not presented was any data or research showing that eliminating the grade-level track and putting these lower performing students in a track designed to prepare them for Algebra I in 8th grade would be efficacious. Nor was any evidence presented on the effects this may have on the higher performing students.

Mr. Dolowich took issue with the October 14th Post's characterization of the new single track as "Compression for all," but failed to clarify if this is then "grade level math for all" or how you can have all students prepared for Algebra in 8th grade without "compression." Put simply, are we raising the bar or lowering it? Would raising the bar help struggling students? Would lowering the bar still engage our high performers? Should we perhaps instead keep two parallel bars with some pathways to jump between them, or even increase the number of bars with more fluid groupings of students on a yearly or semester basis?

The Board's public comments on this lack of evidence essentially boiled down to "we have to do something" and "we are small so we can be nimble." How do the parents and teaching professionals feel about the experiment the Board is running on our middle schoolers? I am hoping my 6th grader continues to thrive in Mr. Barile-Hill's math class and that the experiment will play itself out before my TK'er reaches 6th grade.



How to get news in the *Post*

The *Piedmont Post* welcomes its readers to express their opinions on any topic. Columns in the *Piedmont Post* are exclusive and may not be reprinted without permission.

The *Post* reserves the right to edit any pieces or letters submitted. Opinion pieces should be limited to 400 words, letters to the editor to 200 words.

Photo submissions: Please submit photos at 6 inches in width and at a resolution of 200 dpi in jpeg format.

Do you have some news? Send your photos or stories to 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610, or email them to news@piedmont-post.com. It's that easy. (Send us an attachment or cut and paste your text into the body of the email.)

The deadline for submitting news, photos and opinion items is Friday.

Letters to the Editor

Yes on Measure GG

Editor:

I strongly encourage those reading this to vote yes on Measure GG. I previously spent six years on Piedmont's Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee, including two years as Chair. During that time period, the Committee consistently pointed out the City is facing increasing costs due to inflation and growing need for infrastructure maintenance and capital investment to maintain the level of services that Piedmont residents expect. Given that the City is primarily reliant on property-related tax revenue, and as the Committee pointed out in prior reports, increasing the Transfer Tax as proposed in Measure GG is "the most broad-based and sustainable source for material additional revenue."

Please join me in supporting Measure GG.

–Frank Ryan

Support Measure GG

Editor:

My family and I live on a busy arterial street and a crosswalk used to terminate in our driveway.

Five years ago, our street was identified in Piedmont's Safer Streets Plan as a location where pedestrian and vehicle safety could be improved. About two years ago, funding became available to make these significant improvements in our neighborhood possible.

These changes have made our street so much safer now for pedestrians and cars alike. They were not done in isolation; the City is implementing pedestrian and road safety projects around Piedmont.

We support Measure GG in the hope that the generated revenue can keep our essential services strong and continue to address other important traffic and pedestrian safety projects around town.

We encourage others to support Measure GG.

–Amy and Tom McKenzie

No on Measure GG

Editor:

As a resident of this beautiful city for more than 50 years, I have seen a lot of issues with our local government decisions.

This city spending is outrageously out of control. We have seen this play out over a myriad of projects throughout the years. Most notable is the recent bond issue to fund the swimming complex. This project was over budget by close to fifteen (15) million dollars. I vividly remember that the initial funding vote for this project was held during an "off major election" period, to guarantee a smaller turnout and the passage of the bond issue.

Yesterday I received a mailer from the city recommending the passage of measure GG as "we need more money in the city, and a transfer tax is the way to increase the city's bank balance."

Do we have anyone in our city staff and City Council that can run a prudently financed government? Most of us are tired of paying higher taxes for all the city staff financial miscues.

The city government should not be mailing out a flyer to its citizens recommending passage of this funding. All this information is already in the election pamphlets. The city voters can then make their decision as to the way the city of Piedmont is being run.

–Bob Morrison
8 Littlewood

Measure GG will help the city

Editor:

As a Piedmont resident for over 50 years, I value our community and the things that make it a good place to live. The adage is that people come to Piedmont for the schools and stay for the public services. I've been lucky enough to experience both. As a teacher and principal in our schools, I got to help our children grow and learn. As a community member, I've taken advantage of the recreation, public safety, and other services our tax dollars provide.

Measure GG will help the city catch up with the increasing expenses it faces every day. It proposes a modest increase in a tax only paid when properties are sold. The measure will provide additional revenue, allocated annually and in public, to maintain our essential public services and facilities and to continue the high level of service we expect from our city government.

Piedmont is a town of volunteers, in our schools, in our community, and in our city government. We all contribute time, energy, knowledge, and tax dollars to help maintain our community. I urge you to join me in supporting Measure GG. It will go a long way toward helping our city and our community going forward.

Sincerely,
–Nancy McHugh

Vote No on Measure GG

Editor:

I'm a progressive who believes in government and in paying taxes to support public services. I'm voting No on Measure GG, and I hope you'll join me in sending it back to the City Council for a better version.

I strongly support raising revenue for city services and parks and recreation. As others have pointed out, they're a big reason my family chose Piedmont. But GG is the wrong tool for three main reasons.

First, it's an unreliable revenue source that will hurt homeowners. Studies of transfer taxes in Toronto, New York, and Germany find they reduce the number of home sales and lower prices. Fewer sales means less revenue for the city, but Piedmont needs a sustainable and consistent revenue source.

Second, it's unclear how the money will be spent. GG is a general tax with no dedicated uses and no reporting requirement. Supporters have said it will pay for parks, public safety, and city employee benefits. It can't fund everything mentioned, and voters will have no way to hold the city accountable for how GG funds are spent.

Third, it's a band-aid. Piedmont's budget squeeze comes from having almost no commercial tax base and from Prop 13, which prevents property tax revenue from keeping pace with home values and the real cost of running a city. Prop 13 already makes our revenue depend on who happens to sell, and GG doubles down on that instead of spreading the burden among all homeowners. Not having a commercial tax base is a choice and one we can also fix.

Vote No, and ask the Council to come back with a measure that provides dependable revenue, has dedicated uses, and spreads the costs fairly among all homeowners. I'll vote for that one.

–Erin Yaylali

Urge voters to vote Yes on Measure GG

To the Editor:

As a real estate professional who works with both buyers and sellers in Piedmont, I recognize that increasing the real estate

See Letters on page 25

Perspective

Local ballot measure ratings

Editor:

I am Michael Henn, a longtime Piedmont resident, former Piedmont Planning Commissioner, and three-time member of the Alameda County Civil Grand Jury. The nonpartisan and independent Civil Grand Jury Association, not affiliated with the sitting Grand Jury, evaluates local ballot measures' language for fairness and accuracy. There are eight measures evaluated in the attached report, including one from Piedmont. By chance, Piedmont's Measure H achieved the highest score of the eight. As reported, local ballot measures unfairly exaggerate the measures' benefits while ignoring the costs.

Local ballot measure ratings for Alameda County General Election on Nov. 3

Created by independent Civil Grand Jury Association

The 29 Alameda County local ballot measures scheduled for the November 3, 2026 general election were evaluated in September 2026 by the Alameda County Ballot Watchdog Committee. The measures' titles were evaluated for the accuracy and fairness required by the California Elections Code using criteria established by the committee for each type of ballot measure, e.g., Bond Measure, Tax Measure, and Other (non-tax measure). This article will review Measure GG and Measure RTM.

The collective scores represent the average score arrived at by the evaluators who have served on previous civil grand juries (up to 15 evaluators allowed). The scoring system is comparable to the popular "Yelp" type scoring system (a score of one is worst; five is best). Like a Yelp evaluation, the ratings reflect the average of the evaluators' educated opinions, based on the established criteria as to what should be, and should not be, included in each type of ballot measure.

The Ballot Watchdog group IS NOT evaluating the merits of the measures. The evaluation is non-partisan, neither liberal nor conservative. They are only concerned with the accuracy and impartiality of the up-to-75-word ballot title being presented to the voters. State law requires ballot language to be "a true and impartial synopsis of the purpose of the proposed measure and shall be in language that is neither argumentative nor likely to create prejudice for or against the measure." Unfortunately, local jurisdictions violate the law's intent by exaggerating benefits, glossing over costs, and adding extraneous verbiage designed to favor passage of the measure. It's easy to understand the cause of this bias: No one, other than the agency promoting the measure's passage, is required to approve the agency's language.

To counteract this inherent bias, we need active, consistent monitoring of local government ballot language, aka "Ballot Titles." This current Ballot Watchdog Committee effort implements the findings of the 2021 Alameda County Civil Grand Jury Report, The Need for Accuracy and Impartiality of Ballot Measure Questions.

Additional information on the 2021 report and all other Alameda County Civil Grand Jury Reports is available on the Alameda County website: https://grandjury.acgov.org. Information on the work of the Alameda County Ballot Watchdog Committee is at ballotwatchdog.com.

Results: The Ballot Watchdog Committee's review produced individual ballot measure scores ranging from 1.8 to 4.6. The average was 3.71. The most common matter that caused a reduction in the score was a lack of clarity as to why the measure was needed and what it would cost. Almost as common was the inclusion of extraneous verbiage designed to influence a favorable vote on the measure. Numerous proposed tax increases failed to mention that the new tax is being added to an existing similar tax and what that existing tax is, and what the resulting tax will be. Thus, voters could not learn the amount of increase or even the percent-

See Ballot Ratings on page 25

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Local Items

Adoptable Cats of the Week

By Quinn White



Adopt Joules and Newton through Cat Town.

Add some positive energy to your life by adopting Joules and Newton! These six-month-old brothers play like lively little monkeys — climbing, chasing, and wrestling with one another as if they know their cuteness is a gift to the world.

Newton is likely to take the lead; he's a little more outgoing to start, happily climbing aboard when an inviting lap appears. As the more adventurous brother, he likes to investigate new opportunities to test the laws of physics. Joules will feel safe with a little extra patience. Once he's ready to show off, this tiny tuxedo has an adorable habit of standing up on his back feet to box at his toys.

Watching them tire one another out is a real joy, and it's even more fun to help these tiny scientists learn the meaning of family. With this pair, you can look forward to plenty of cuddles, lazy naps in the sun, and tiny rumbling purrs when you pet them softly.

Joules and Newton would be great best friends for first-time adopters, or even a family with older kids or teens. They are neutered, vaccinated, microchipped, and FeLV/FIV negative. Learn more at www.cattownoakland.org or email adopt@cattownoakland.org.

Profile: City Council candidate Adam Hundt

By Jake Lannon



Adam Hundt

In November, Piedmont residents will vote to fill three seats on the City Council. Among the candidates running for City Council is Adam Hundt, a Bay Area resident for 20 years who moved to Piedmont in 2021 with his wife and two young children. Hundt has a 14-year career in the technology industry, primarily in e-commerce, and now works in the energy and climate sector, most recently on a California wildfire risk mitigation project.

Hundt grew up in Maryland and holds an MBA and masters degree in industrial engineering from the University of Michigan and a public policy degree from Johns Hopkins University. His first job in tech was working for eBay in the mid-2000s. He learned that well-designed platforms and incentives can help people transact and create value for both sides.

"eBay was a company that was doing well by doing good by creating opportunities for small business entrepreneurs to be successful merchants on their marketplace platform, and so that was appealing to me from a values perspective," said Hundt.

Hundt transitioned away from the tech industry into public policy because he wanted to help build a better world.

"My interest in government comes from my youth, growing up around the federal government and my desire in my professional life to take roles that would make a positive impact on people's lives," said Hundt.

Hundt believes we have the technology to lower carbon emissions and build a better environment. But the biggest obstacle is getting businesses to adopt these changes. This is a problem he feels adequately equipped to solve.

"It feels like I can use my business skills to help solve that type of problem. I found from my business life that if there's a clear financial incentive to do something, it becomes a huge motivator for someone to act and adopt a service or a product," said Hundt.

Hundt's passion for public policy inspired him to run for Piedmont's City Council. He was attracted to the position after experiencing the strong sense of community in Piedmont and his desire to make a positive impact in the area where he now resides.

"We're making a home here in Piedmont. This is an opportunity to have a positive impact on our children's lives, as well as the lives of all the residents. That's a very exciting opportunity that I would love to be a part of," said Hundt.

Hundt likes to spend time with his wife and children and describes himself as a film aficionado. Hundt is is a member of the SF Film and the Berkeley Pacific Film Archive, where he'll watch an old classic if he has the time. When asked for his top three movies, he responded with *The Princess Bride*, *Big* starring Tom Hanks, and *Say Anything*.

Nominations open for Alameda County Women's Hall of Fame

The Alameda County Women's Hall of Fame (WHOF) is now accepting nominations for its 2027 class inductees and applications for its Mary V. King/Wilma Chan Youth Scholarship Program.

Community members are encouraged to nominate outstanding women in the following categories: Business & Professions, Culture & Art, Community Service, Education, Emerging Leaders, Environmental, Health, Justice, Non-Traditional, Philanthropy, Science/Technology/Engineering, and Sports & Athletics.

The Women's Hall of Fame is also accepting applications for the Mary V. King/Wilma Chan Youth Scholarship Program, which will award up to six $5,000 scholarships to outstanding high school seniors who demonstrate academic achievement, community involvement, leadership, and perseverance in overcoming challenges.

The deadline to submit an inductee nomination or youth scholarship application is November 6, 2026. Up to twelve Women's Hall of Fame inductees and six youth scholarship recipients will be recognized at the 2027 Alameda County Women's Hall of Fame Luncheon and award ceremony on Saturday, March 27, 2027, at The Club at Castlewood in Pleasanton.

Proceeds from the Women's Hall of Fame luncheon and related activities help support programs benefiting women and families throughout Alameda County. For nomination and scholarship eligibility requirements, application materials, and additional information, visit www.acgov.org/whof.

Profile: City Council candidate Nancy Beninati

By Jake Lannon



Nancy Beninati

Nancy Beninati is running for one of the three open seats on Piedmont's City Council. Beninati grew up in New York, went to Cornell University, and went to law school at the Golden Gate University School of Law. She has two kids attending Piedmont High School and has been married for over 20 years.

Beninati began her legal career in Walnut Creek representing the families of people who had died in the Oakland Hills fire. Since then, she's dedicated her legal career to helping people

"I've taken my professional career on a trajectory of helping people. I've spent over 20 years focused on civil rights and civil rights enforcement," said Beninati.

Beninati served 27 years at the California Department of Justice as a Supervising Deputy Attorney General and now teaches law and public policy at the Goldman School of Public Policy. She has held multiple leadership roles with the League of Women Voters Piedmont, including serving two terms as its President. She currently serves on the Piedmont Recreation Commission and previously served as Chair of the Piedmont Civil Service Commission.

One of her accomplishments she's most proud of in her legal career is her work on racial profiling. Beninati led a Racial and Identity Profiling Advisory Board that collected data from over 500 police departments in California on this issue. The board relesed annual reports and worked with police departments on reform efforts.

"It's helped in a lot of the police reform work that I did. We used the racial and identity profiling data and information that we got to inform our reforms in cities like San Francisco and Bakersfield," said Beninati.

Beninati plans to scale back from her work at the California Department of Justice to focus on her teaching. With this extra time, she decided to run for Piedmont City Council to continue working in public policy and serve the community.

"I love public policy and being involved in community service. I think it's a good time for me to run for council. I really value listening to the community, and I have the government and public policy experience," said Beninati.

She values Piedmont's community engagement and the accessibility of city employees to talk about the decisions the city makes.

"I appreciate being able to walk down to town hall and talk to the building planner directly, where I know that that's not necessarily a situation in other larger cities," said Beninati.

After the election is over, Beninati plans to participate in the Wednesday Walkers tours to see the history of the city and learn more about her family's history in Piedmont.

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Get the 411 on voting

The nonpartisan League of Women Voters Education Fund has launched VOTE411.org. Readers can sign up with their city and street address to receive updates about their local races. The website provides updates, candidate priorities, qualifications to hold office, and answers to important community questions.

Candidate answers will be side by side so voters can compare them directly. The candidates are not ranked or endorsed. VOTE411.org costs nothing, requires no institutional endorsement, and keeps judgment where it belongs — with the voter.

After signing up, the site will show you your complete ballot, including measures, a description of the position the candidate is running for, and your registration status. If you are not registered to vote, VOTE411.org allows you to register in just two minutes.

Contact Kathleen Quenneville, the local coordinator, for more information at kquenneville@cavote411.org.

Keb' Mo' to headline Oakland benefit honoring Peter Coyote

By Caitlin Alegre

Northern Light School will present a night with five-time Grammy winner Keb' Mo' & Friends on Saturday, October 24, at the Jeannik Méquet Littlefield Concert Hall in Oakland on the Mills College campus. The evening honors Peter Coyote, the actor, author, and storyteller, for more than two decades of partnership with the school, and will raise essential funding for the school's programming. Doors open at 6:00 p.m., and the performance begins at 7:00 p.m.

Blues musician Keb' Mo' will headline an acoustic performance limited to 414 seats. He will be joined by surprise guests introduced from the stage. The evening will also include tributes to Peter Coyote and a look back at Northern Light School's 37 years of transformative whole-child education.

Rather than a public ticket sale, seats are released through a private invitation registry. Supporters may request an invitation at nlsbenefitconcert.org. The host committee reviews requests and sends an accepted applicant a private reservation link. Once you receive the private reservation link, you may then purchase tickets.

Event sponsors are invited to a pre-concert reception featuring tapas and bites to celebrate the influence of blues music on American culture, along with fine wines and craft beers. Event proceeds support the Northern Light School.

Piedmont Boosters Club to host large fundraising event

By Jake Lannon

The Piedmont Boosters Club is hosting its largest fundraising event, Oktoberfest, this Saturday, October 24. The Club relies on these community fundraiser events to support high school athletics. The event will feature a beer garden with local craft breweries and a premium wine-and-spritz station, held at the Community Hall from 4 to 9 p.m.

The Athletics Boosters Club was founded in 1978 to help Piedmont's school athletic programs. According to the Boosters Club's website, over 78% of Piedmont High School students participate in athletics across 48 teams and 17 sports. The school district provides essentials such as uniforms, field and practice space, and protective equipment; anything further relies on outside sources of funding.



A group having fun at the 2025 Oktoberfest.

"We come in where the district can't," said Boosters Club President Keri Elmquist. "Beyond the basic supplies, it falls on us to help supply the teams for our student athletes. We stepped in as boosters to do that."

In her sixth year as president, Elmquist has witnessed the positive effects of supporting youth athletics.

"My three kids all came through Piedmont in various sports, and it was probably the highlight of all of their high school careers," Elmquist continued. "There's nothing like playing for your team in your town, in front of your friends and your families. To the extent we can just get behind that in any and every way possible, that's our mission."

To support these athletes, the Club contributes to the teams through grant distributions. Each team has a liaison to represent it. The team captains and coaches can approach these liaisons with a grant request. The coach and liaison will write an explanation of what they need and where they'd source it. The executive committee and board do an initial evaluation of the request before voting on it at their monthly meeting.

These requests typically pertain to improving individual teams' equipment, athletic departments, facilities, and, in some cases, capital improvements. Elmquist gave an example of what they fund. The lacrosse team requested practice sticks to help new kids in the program who had never played before and did not have their own equipment.

To fund these grant requests, the Club hosts fundraisers and paid memberships to support the programs. Oktoberfest is the Club's biggest event, and they expect to raise about $50,000 for the Boosters Club through ticket sales and sponsorships.

Athletes will volunteer to prepare and serve food to guests. General admission provides five pours of beer or wine, one sausage, and one pretzel. Ticket packages can be purchased online at https://www.piedmontoktoberfest.com/.

The Piedmont Athletics Boosters Club is a nonprofit organization that supports athletics at Piedmont High School and the middle schools.





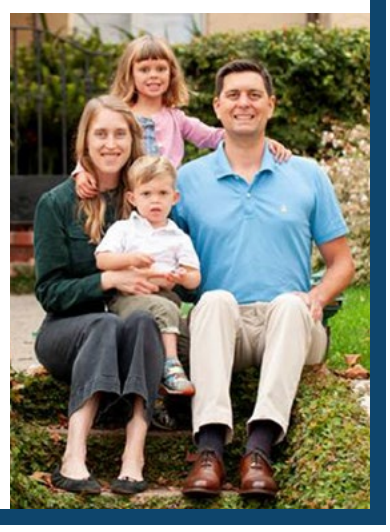
ADAM HUNDT
for Piedmont City Council

Dear Piedmont residents:

My name is Adam Hundt. I am running to be a member of the City Council. My wife is a proud Cal Bear. We are raising two young children, ages 2 and 4. Our 4-year-old attends the Havens TK program.

If elected, I will seek affordable options for home electrification and energy efficiency, lowering electricity bills and increasing home values. I can also use my two decades of education and business experience to find ways to attract small businesses into our town to provide family-friendly services such as a café or ice cream shop.

I will prioritize safety, ensuring our highly valued Police and Fire Departments continue to provide rapid responses to medical and other emergencies. I will help the city maintain its beautiful parks while addressing infrastructure needs including the improvement of sewers and storm drains.



I'm honored to be endorsed by the Alameda County Democratic Party, California State Controller Malia M. Cohen, California State Senator Jesse Arreguin (District 7), and many Piedmont residents. For more information, go to my website AdamHundt.com.

I humbly ask for your vote by November 3, 2026.

Sincerely,
Adam Hundt

adamhundt.com

Paid for by Adam Hundt for Piedmont City Council 2026, FPPC # 1496695

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Schools

Community support fuels educational excellence in Piedmont

At the October meeting of the Piedmont Education Foundation (PEF) Board of Directors, Interim Superintendent Donald Evans shared how lucky he felt to be able to come back to a school district that has such incredible community support. He thanked the board of the PEF for the countless hours of volunteering they do to raise funds for PUSD. These funds enable Piedmont schools to continue as one of the top school districts in California.

This is a sentiment he shared previously. At an event in 2022, Dr. Evans emphasized the unique nature of what community generosity makes possible across Piedmont's schools.



PEF Board Vice Chair Marco Gonzalez-Navarro distributes information about the Giving Campaign in front of Havens School.

"If you go up and down the state [of California], you don't see fully structured art programs. You don't see structured music programs or technology programs. You don't see fully operational libraries. Even in some of the highest-achieving districts, you will not see all those things like you see here," noted Dr. Evans.

The financial backing provided by PEF through its annual Giving Campaign directly translates into crucial classroom resources, educator salaries, and essential student services. Over 90% of PEF's annual base grant directly supports instructor salaries and benefits, ensuring that Piedmont public schools retain educators and maintain manageable class sizes across all grade levels.

Educators throughout the Piedmont Unified School District consistently express deep gratitude for the community's financial contributions. Funding raised through the Giving Campaign secures resources that allow teachers to focus on providing a compassionate, rigorous, and well-rounded learning environment for every student.



Former PEF Board Chair Dana Lung (right) and PEF staff member Amy Cordani set up for the Giving Campaign's launch day outside the high school.

With a state funding gap of $2,528 per student this year, PEF relies on broad community participation to meet its annual grant commitments. The theme of this year's Giving Campaign, "It Takes All of Us," serves as a reminder that community investment is essential to maintaining the high standard of education that defines Piedmont.

PEF encourages every family and community member to contribute to the Giving Campaign. Contributions of any size directly touch the lives of students and empower educators to deliver an outstanding educational experience.

To learn more about the Giving Campaign or to make a tax-deductible donation, please visit PiedmontEdFoundation.org/donate or contact the PEF office at (510) 653-1816.

Thinking Outside the Classroom

Dark matter: A mystery in our cosmos

By Cameron Schneider

The universe we live in is filled with many unknowns. Scientists do their best to completely understand their discoveries, but there are some things that remain shrouded in mystery. One of the greater mysteries of our cosmos is dark matter. Unlike regular matter, which can easily be perceived, dark matter is an invisible substance. By unlocking the mysteries of dark matter, scientists learn more about our universe.

A Mysterious Discovery

Dark matter has been an ongoing mystery for scientists for decades. It wasn't until the 1970s that the existence of dark matter was accepted by the scientific community. While observing spiral galaxies, astronomer Vera Rubin noted that there must be something keeping the stars on the outer edge of the spiral from flying out into space. Based on her observations, Rubin concluded that the invisible glue keeping the stars in place must be dark matter. Although there is still debate from scientists on what exactly dark matter could be, its general existence is widely agreed upon.

The Clues We Have So Far

Although we know dark matter exists, scientists have a limited understanding of what exactly it is. It is known that dark matter has gravity and that it doesn't emit, reflect, absorb, or even block light; it simply passes through normal matter just like a ghost. Although dark matter doesn't interact with light, scientists have observed that its gravity can cause light from distant galaxies to bend, an effect scientists have called gravitational lensing. By studying gravitational lensing, scientists can better understand dark matter and its effects on the universe.

Scientists believe that our universe is made up of 5% visible matter, 27% dark matter, and 68% dark energy. Like dark matter, dark energy is another mysterious force in our universe that scientists know relatively nothing about. Together, dark matter and dark energy make up 95% of our universe, meaning the majority of our universe is completely unknown. Although this can be a spooky fact to know, it can also be exciting because it means there will be more to learn and discover in the future.

Spooky Science

To learn more about the spooky scientific mysteries in our universe, spend the day at Chabot Space & Science Center on Saturday, October 31 for our Spooky Science event. Trick-or-treat across the universe, enjoy spooky science-themed activities, and learn about the mysteries of our world!

FUN4KIDS Event Calendar

By Jay Russell

Pumpkin Patch & Haunted House
Pumpkinpatch.info/welcome/index.html
4414 Piedmont Avenue, Oakland; 967-9363

This pumpkin patch and haunted house is located right next to J.Miller Flowers on Piedmont Avenue. The patch, which has operated seasonally since 1996, has a wide variety of pumpkins, with Halloween costumes and decorations for sale as well. Admission is $10 per person for the haunted house, but entry to the pumpkin patch and store is free. The patch is open daily from 9:00 a.m.-8:00 p.m. The haunted house is described as moderately scary but is designed to be appropriate for all ages.

Cal Academy of Sciences
Calacademy.org
Golden Gate Park, 55 Music Concourse Dr., S.F.;
(415) 379-8000

Head west to see the Cal Academy's four-story rainforest, full of butterflies and flora, and an aquarium that reaches down to the California Coast's sea floor. Kids will enjoy vicariously joining the colony of endangered African penguins, and their imaginations will take off while visiting the Swamp and Aquarium sections. The Academy is open everyday 9:30 a.m.-5:00 p.m., with a late opening of 11:00 on Sundays. Look into a membership for early morning admissions.

Crab Cove Visitor Center
Ebparks.org/parks/visitor-centers/crab-cove
1231 McKay Avenue, Alameda; 544-3187

Visit Crab Cove Beach while the weather remains warm. Check out the Doug Siden Visitor Center in Alameda to learn about creatures of the Bay. Walk out onto the muddy shores to look for crabs, or just relax on the lawn. Join Fish Feeding viewings Wednesdays from 3:00-3:30 p.m. to get an up close view of Crab Cove's crabs, flounder, perch, and other species as they are fed by the center's biologist. The center is open Wed.-Sun. 10:00 a.m.-5:00 p.m. through October.

ADVERTISE IN THE *POST*



Official or artificial? Gen Z's take on AI

By Ayla Blanford

From explaining concepts to generating entire assignments, artificial intelligence is changing how Generation Z students approach school work. By offering instant explanations and assistance on assignments, AI appeals to students, however this generation maintains a healthy fear of the dangers its capabilities hold.

At Piedmont High School (PHS), students use AI platforms like ChatGPT, Claude, and Google Gemini to help them study for tests, and refresh material on topics that they aren't as confident in, junior Izara Dando said.

"I think it's a helpful resource for understanding concepts and it provides me with practice tests that are efficient," Dando said.

The curriculum at PHS moves quickly, especially in advanced courses. Junior Quinn Wagener said she uses AI to go over material she didn't fully understand during class.

"It helps me learn better when I can fully grasp the main ideas of the concept," Wagener said. "When I am stuck on a concept, I can ask it to explain it to me."

Although AI is commonly viewed as a helpful resource, students acknowledge the dangers of using platforms excessively.

"The more students use AI consistently, the more we rely on it for assignments," Wagener said. "This could negatively affect how we comprehend ideas with no AI use."

As Gen Z becomes further dependent on AI, it is beginning to affect the way people think and operate on a daily basis, junior Noah Baldwin said.

"AI is further reinforcing the loss of creativity," Baldwin said. "It is causing growing minds to become people with limited imaginations."

To ensure that they don't become dependent, students are focusing on the importance of limiting their AI use. Dando said she acknowledges the dangers AI holds in the future and takes that into consideration in her everyday life.

"In the future it might make people less critical and take away opportunities of occupations," Dando said.

The dangers of AI use largely depend on the user themselves, and the extent that they rely on the platform, Dando said.

"Some people may misuse AI and grow to depend on it, but for others I think it can be beneficial," Dando said

Over the past few years, students have seen an increase in the use of AI, because of its ability to provide support and help for assignments and everyday tasks, Wagener said.

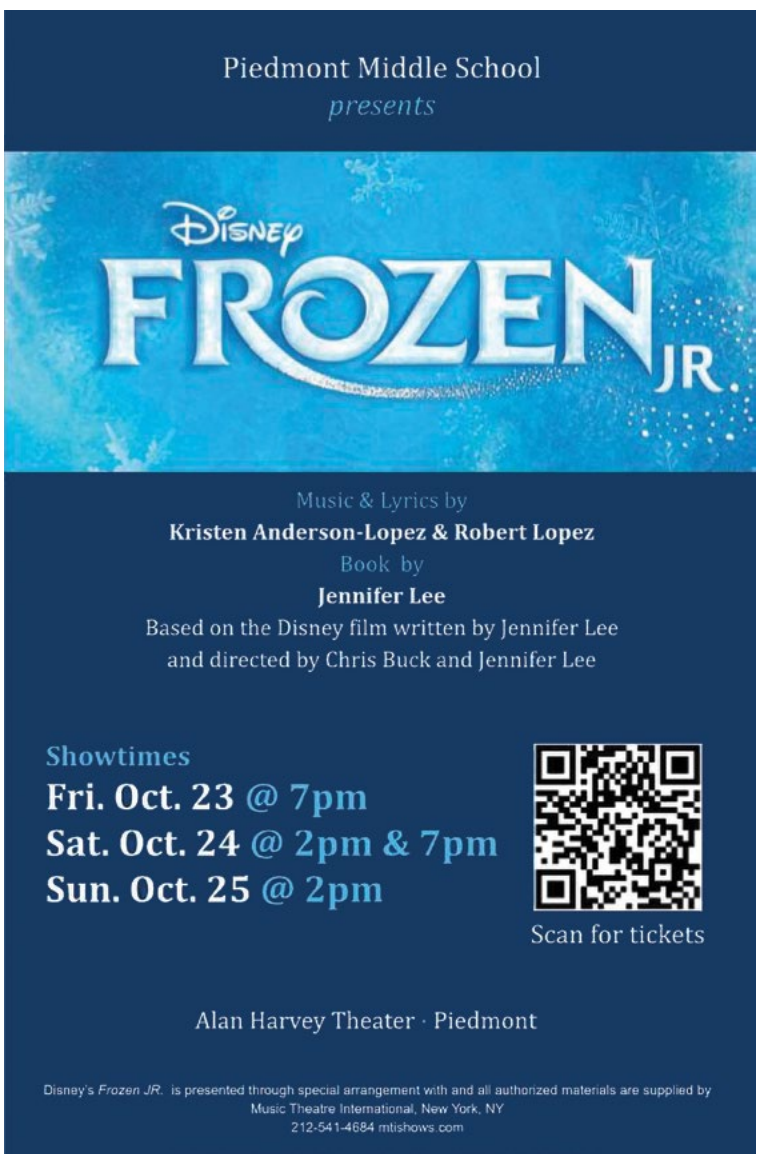
"It has increased but not by much. I think as my workload increases I use it more because I get more drained and can't fully comprehend what I am learning," Wagener said.

At Piedmont High School, the AI Overview Google page has been blocked on all school-issued Chromebooks. This new restriction has made it more difficult for students to access AI when looking up topics or questions, Dando said.

"It's difficult because no matter what you look up, you have to scroll through various links to find the answer you are searching for, which you may never find," Dando said.

When it comes to AI usage, current students must balance the need for speedy answers with the desire to fight off technology dependence. How much AI aid each student needs can correlate to looming deadlines and heavy courseloads, making time management and structure increasingly important.

Ayla Blanford is a Piedmont High School junior and a student writer intern for the Piedmont Post.



PMS musical *Frozen JR.* coming October 23-25

By Amy Moorhead

Piedmont Middle School presents *Frozen JR.* October 23-25, based on the 2018 Broadway musical. The show features all of the memorable songs from the animated film, with music and lyrics by Kristen Anderson-Lopez and Robert Lopez, plus five new songs written for the Broadway production.

A story of true love and acceptance between sisters, F*rozen JR.* expands upon the emotional relationship and journey between Princesses Anna and Elsa. When faced with danger, the two discover their hidden potential and the powerful bond of sisterhood. With a cast of beloved characters and loaded with magic, adventure, and plenty of humor, *Frozen JR.* is sure to thaw even the coldest heart.

Frozen JR. runs approximately 75 minutes, including intermission, and is appropriate for the entire family. Performances are Friday, October 23, 7:00 p.m., Saturday, October 24, 2:00 p.m. & 7:00 p.m., and Sunday, October 25, 2:00 p.m. All performances are at the Alan Harvey Theater. Tickets are available for purchase online at https://phsmusicalsdance.ludus.com/index.php

Math Pathways

Continued from page 1

student advancement. The proposed new pathway allows students multiple opportunities to advance while in middle school. Approving a new pathway must occur before adopting a new curriculum in order to effectively address both matters.

Q: *How does the data support a new pathway?*

A: Although PUSD stands as a high-achieving district overall, there is clearly room for improvement when the data is disaggregated.

Recent district data at the middle school level based on CAASPP reveals the following:

- 96% of students on the compressed path meet or exceed math standards
- 53% of students on the grade-level path meet or exceed math standards
- Approximately a third of our middle schoolers are on this grade-level path
- Prior to COVID, more than 80% of grade-level students met standards. Six years later, this group is more than 40 percentage points behind its peers
- Only 19% of students in Math Lab, our current support class, met standards last year

Q: *What are the parameters of the new pathway?*

A: Please find the guidelines for the new pathway below.

- Encourages more students to complete Algebra I in 8th grade & Calculus in 12th grade
- No path needs selection – Flexible on-ramps and off-ramps exist throughout
- Built-in curriculum-agnostic assessments to help indicate readiness and advancement
- Math specialists provide additional Tier 1 math support in grades 6 & 7
- Grade 8 offers a rigorous Pre-Algebra II course as an option or an off-ramp
- Summer study and assessed achievement options offered for advancement/recovery
- Grade 11 students may reach Calculus without having to take concurrent math courses
- New pathways intended to address and close any prior grade learning gaps for all students

Q: *Can you provide additional details with respect to the Math 6 Foundations class?*

A: The Math 6 Foundations class is not compression for all and is designed to include a full year's worth of math standards with intentional support. See details below:

- 6th grade: Nearly all students take the same rigorous 6th grade math curriculum, with extra support available.
- 7th grade: Students take Pre-Algebra I, with extra support as needed. This is the one year that will cover more content.
- 8th grade: A growing number of students will continue to Algebra I. Students who need or want more time will take Pre-Algebra II followed by Algebra I in 9th grade. Readiness will be the primary consideration.

To be clear, there is one year, in 7th grade, where students will have advanced pacing and cover more content. Pre-Algebra I combines 7th grade standards with some 8th grade standards and strategic built-in support will be provided. Placement in Pre-Algebra II or Algebra will strictly follow readiness.

Q: *What decision was made at the Oct. 14th Board meeting?*

A: The Board approved new secondary math pathways, still subject to refinement, which will inform the selection of the newly adopted curriculum, scheduled to be implemented in the 2027-28 school year.

Q: *What is the proposed pathway?*

A: See chart below

Q: *How does this serve students who may find math challenging, including those with Individualized Education Programs (IEPs) or 504 plans?*

A: The new pathway approach is aimed at helping all students: those "in the middle" who are so often overlooked, those who are interested in acceleration, and those students who find math challenging. Today, many of these students are placed on a separate path early. Unfortunately, this has yielded mixed results at best: only 53% of current grade-level pathway students meet state standards, and only 19% of Math Lab students meet state standards. In addition to providing more support for students in the Math 6 and Pre-Algebra I classes, we believe there is an opportunity to rethink middle school math interventions. We look forward to working with staff to determine appropriate support for all students.

Moreover, individual student plans still take precedence. Pathway changes will not override a student's IEP or 504 plan. Each student's IEP or 504 team still determines the placement, services, and accommodations a student needs.

Q: *What are the next steps with respect to collaboration with teaching staff*

A: The teachers at PUSD are amazing - they have deep subject matter expertise, along with the specific knowledge of teaching OUR students. We look forward to working in collaboration with members of the secondary math adoption committee to determine decisions such as:

- Refinements of Approved Math Pathway
- PUSD Math Placement Policy
- Articulating Standards Covered in Each Course
- Transition Plan for Implementation
- Proceed with secondary curriculum adoption
  - Pilot curricular materials, Jan.- May, 2027
  - Recommendation to Board, May 26, 2027

Pathway	6th Grade	7th Grade	8th Grade	9th Grade	10th Grade	11th Grade	12th Grade
College Prep	Math 6: Math Foundations	Pre-Algebra I	Algebra I	Geometry -or- Honors Geo	Algebra II -or- Honors Algebra II	Pre-Calc -or- Stats	AP Calc. AB
Advanced	Pre-Algebra I	Algebra I	Geometry Honors	Algebra II Honors	AP Pre-Calc	AP Calc. BC -or- Honors Stats	Advanced course of choice or- Dual Enrollment
College Prep II			Pre-Algebra II	Algebra I	Geometry	Algebra II	Pre-Calc -or- Stats

**Math Assessment Process: Per PUSD policy, students may take a readiness assessment each year for purposes of skipping courses and ensuring appropriate course placement.

** The names of the Pathway and courses (including College Prep, Advanced and College Prep II), are still in draft mode and have not yet been finalized.

Troop 15's backpacking trip to Point Reyes

By Avery Chau, Troop 15

In early October, Troop 15 took our first backpacking trip of the season, and we had loads of fun hiking and running around on the beach. The trip was originally supposed to be to Desolation Wilderness, but the forecast showed cold weather, dangerous rain, and possible snow, so we couldn't go. Our youngest sixth-grade scouts were all attending, and we wanted to make sure they had a successful first trip. Instead, we managed to secure a spot at the Point Reyes Wildcat campsite.

The hike to camp was 5.7 miles each way, and the scenery was breathtaking. The gorgeous view of the beach meeting the glistening water completely took our breath away. When we got to camp, everyone decided who would tent where, and then we set up.

"I had a great time hiking with my group of fellow scouts. It was challenging with ups and downs but I really enjoyed it," said Abigail Gregovich.

After that, we still had enough time to explore, so we all headed to the beach to walk around. It was very beautiful, other than the many dead animals we saw, including birds, seals, and even a deer. When we left the beach, we walked back to camp and made dinner. All of the food was meant for Desolation, so it wasn't grand. It was just meant to refuel everyone.



Troop 15 Scouts successfully completed an overnight backpacking trip to a Point Reyes campsite earlier this month.



Troop 15 scouts Everett C, Evie L, Julian T, Lucian F, and Augie L cook out under a blue Marin sky during an October 2026 trip to Point Reyes.

After eating, we settled down for a closing circle. We took some time to admire the shining stars you never see in the city, and we even saw a shooting star! Then we all got into our tents for the night.

The next day, we got up early and hiked the final 5.7 miles back to the parking lot. On the way home, we stopped at Mr. Green Bubble as a reward for all the hiking we did.

Lessons Learned

The scouts also learned some lessons on this trip:

1. Listen to your body. Hot spots on your feet can lead to blisters.
2. Don't pack things you don't need, and talk to your group about who is bringing what.
3. Always bring enough water for the hike (or have very good fellow scouts who share theirs).



Troop 15 Scouts Colin W (front), Avery C, Amos Y, Muyan H, Sammy C, Reed C, Everett C, Evie L, and Abby G pivoted from weather-related canceled plans in Desolation Wilderness to instead go backpacking in Point Reyes.



Scouts Rowan C, Augie L, and Ulysses S stand on a Point Reyes clifftop with parents Jen G, Josh B and Mike C in the back row.

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STREET SWEEPING SCHEDULE – 2026-27

Street sweeping is critical for keeping storm drains clear during leaf drop season. Residents should move cars and any other obstacles blocking access to the curb off the street on street sweeping days.

October 19 - 30

Mon.	Tues.	Wed.	Thur.	Fri.
October 19	20	21	22	23
1-Odd	**2-O**	**3-O**	**4-O**	**5-O**
October 26	27	28	29	30
1-Even	**2-E**	**3-E**	**4-E**	**5-E**

E = Even Street Numbers O = Odd Street Numbers

Streets, by Zones — **Indicates streets where both even and odd addresses are swept on "even" days*

ZONE 1
Ashmount Ave
Cambrian Ave
Cavanagh Ct *
Crest Rd
Crocker Ave
(South of La Salle Ave)
Croydon Circle *
Estates Dr
Florada Ave
Glen Alpine Rd
Hampton Rd
(East of Sea View Ave)
Huntleigh Rd
Indian Rd
Indian Gulch Rd
Inverleith Terr
La Salle Ave
La Salle Ct *
Lafayette Ave
Lexford Rd
Marlborough Ct *
Muir Ave
Sandringham Pl
Sandringham Rd
Sea View Ave
(Between La Salle & Crocker)
Selborne Dr
Somerset Rd
Sotelo Ave
St James Circle
St James Dr
St James Place
Trestle Glen Rd
Tyson Circle
Valant Place
Wildwood Gdns
Wistaria Way
Woodland Way
Wyngaard Ave

ZONE 2
Arroyo Ave
Bonita Ave
(North of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(West of Grand Ave)
Estrella Ave
Grand Ave – *ODD*
(Bet Wildwood & Cambridge)
Grand Ave
(Between Cambridge & Rose including Lower Grand)
Greenbank Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Holly Place
Howard Ave
Kingston Ave
Lake Ave
Linda Ave
Lorita Ave
Lower Grand Ave
Manor Dr
Monticello Ave
Nace Ave
Oakland Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Olive Ave
Park Way
(Between Monticello & Bonita)
Parkside Dr *
Ramona Ave
Ronada Ave
Rose Ave
Sunnyside Ave
York Dr

ZONE 3
Arbor Dr
Artuna Ave *
Blair Ave
(Below Highland)
Bonita Ave
(South of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(East of Grand Ave)
Carmel Ave
Dale Ave
Dracena Ave
El Cerrito Ave
Fairview Ave
Grand Ave – *EVEN*
(Between Wildwood & Cambridge)
Greenbank Ave
(East of Grand Ave)
Highland Ave
(North of Mountain Ave)
Highland Way
Hill Lane *
Hillside Ave
Hillside Ct **(Hand Blow)*
Jerome Ave
Keefer Ct *
Larmer Ct *
Latham St
MacKinnon Pl *
Magnolia Ave
Moraga Ave
(West of Highland)
Nova Dr
Oakland Ave
(Between Grand & Highland)
Park View Ave
(Between Magnolia & 241 Park View)
Park Way
(Between Bonita & Highland)
Ricardo Ave
San Carlos Ave
Sylvan Way
Vista Ave
Waldo Ave

ZONE 4
Abbott Way *
Alta Ave
Bell Ave
Bellevue Ave
Blair Ave
(Above Highland)
Blair Place *
Calvert Ct
Craig Ave
Dormidera Ave
Dudley Ave
Dudley Ct *
Echo Lane *
Hagar Ave
Hardwick Ave
Langdon Ct *
Littlewood Dr
Maxwelton Rd
Mesa Ave
Monte Ave
Moraga Ave
(East of Highland)
Mountain Ave
(West of Sharon)
Nellie Ave *
Oakland Ave
(Between Highland & Scenic)
Pacific Ave
Pala Ave
Park Way
(Between Highland & Pala)
Scenic Ave
Sharon Ave
Sharon Ct

ZONE 5
Annerley Rd
Boulevard Way
Caperton Ave
Crocker Ave
(North of La Salle Ave)
Crofton Ave
Farragut Ave
Guilford Rd
Hampton Rd
(West of Sea View Ave)
Harvard Rd
Hazel Lane
Highland Ave
(South of Mountain Ave)
King Ave
Lakeview Ave
Lincoln Ave
Mountain Ave
(East of Sharon)
Oak Rd
Oakmont Ave
Palm Dr
Park Lane
Park View Ave
(Between 241 Park View & Winsor)
Piedmont Ct *
(Hand Blow)
Poplar Way
Portsmouth Rd
Prospect Rd
Ranleigh Way
Requa Pl
Requa Rd
Richardson Way
Sea View Ave
(Between Mountain & La Salle)
Sheridan Ave
Sierra Ave
Wallace Rd
Warfield Ave
Wildwood Ave
Winsor Ave

Subscribe to *Street Sweeping Email Updates* (https://lp.constantcontactpages.com/su/2tJcrMR/streetsweepalerts) to get reminders about upcoming street sweeping dates. The Piedmont Public Works Department sends out the weekly schedule to this list every Sunday during street sweeping season.

Street sweeping tips for residents

To help Piedmont's Department of Public Works keep the streets free of leaves during the fall and winter months, residents are asked to observe four rules:

1. Do not put branches in the street, even small branches! They damage the street sweeping equipment.
2. Do not sweep debris from your yard into the gutter – sweep only leaves that fall naturally into the street.
3. Sweep leaves into narrow rows outside the flow line of the gutter. Do not put them in piles. The street sweepers cannot pick up piles of leaves effectively.
4. If you want to rake your leaves, you can now add them to your weekly unlimited green waste cart. If you don't have enough room in your cart, free compostable bags are available at City Hall to place with your green cart on garbage day. Do not bag them and then empty the bags on the street on sweeping day. Compostable bags are also available from Republic Services (1-800-320-8077) for a fee.



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You can now make your cemetery and mortuary arrangements in the same location. From traditional ground burial and services, to cremation and more progressive services, whatever your needs are, we are here to help you. Piedmont Funeral Services is now open to serve the funerary needs of our community.

TEL: 510-658-2588
WWW.PIEDMONTFUNERALSERVICES.COM
5000 PIEDMONT AVE., OAKLAND, CA (FD#2210)

PPD Blue

Excerpts from the Piedmont Police Department Log

October 9 - 16

The Week by the Numbers
1 Catalytic Converter Theft
1 Report of Fraud
1 Residential Burgery
1 ALPR triggered (Automatic License Plate Reader)
2 Arrests

Friday, October 9

7:16 p.m. Magnolia Ave. Report of person at the baseball field, behind the back stop, charging his phone. Officer makes contact, person advised and leaving.

10:27 p.m. Wildwood Ave. Report of juveniles in alleyway making noise, neighbor just wants them to take it inside. Officer finds large crowd of juveniles, crowd is dispersing up and down Wildwood Ave.

Saturday, October 10

10:52 a.m. Wildwood Ave. **Residential Burglary.** Report of package theft at 7:26 p.m. the previous night. Video submitted.

10:03 p.m. Grand Ave. Report of transient woman in wheelchair, has been in front of house all day. Officer made contact earlier, resources refused.

10:22 p.m. King Ave. Report of 30-40 juveniles at house party. Officer on scene, more than 100 juveniles clear out. Intoxicated teen transported to hospital.

10:31 p.m. Sea View Ave. Report of white panel van looping around area.

10:43 p.m. Highland Ave. Report of intoxicated driver in white truck. Officers advised.

Sunday, October 11

8:50 a.m. Blair Ave. Report of outside speakers blasting talk show.

9:51 a.m. Bell Ave. Report of child accidentally locked in parked brown Lexus, Sister can't get into the car. Fire department responds; child is safe.

Monday, October 12

11:56 a.m. Oakland Ave. Report of beeping sound heard in area for 45 minutes. Officer on scene, smoke coming from side of home. House full of smoke, no fire. Smoke cleared out, homeowner en route.

11:38 p.m. Wildwood Ave. **Arrest.** Report of man at residence's backdoor. Person then moves to neighbor's yard. Officer on scene detains person. Suspect arrested for trespassing and is taken to Santa Rita Jail.

Tuesday, October 13

9:54 a.m. Highland Ave. Resident reports finding airtag in her car. Officer meets with resident to provide advice.

10:52 a.m. Grand Ave. **ALPR** triggered by red Honda with white hood. Vehicle parks in Ace. Officer makes contact with registered owner, an expired report on plates reported stolen was still in effect.

Wednesday, October 14

2:10 a.m. Harrison St., Oakland. **Arrest.** Bike rider stopped for riding without lights. Suspect has active warrants for making threats. Person arrested and taken to Santa Rita Jail.

2:48 a.m. Jerome Ave. Officer spots 4-door black sedan speed away. No lights activated, area canvased.

5:24 a.m. Rose Ave. **Catalytic Converter Theft.** Three suspects from gray Mazda 3 steal converter from parked SUV.

11:04 a.m. Jerome Ave. **Fraud.** Report of AT&T account opened in resident's name without permission.

11:34 a.m. Artuna Ave. Report of woman in minivan that appears to be selling goods from vehicle. Officer makes contact, subject advised of PCO and is packing up.

7:25 p.m. York Dr. Report of man ringing doorbell and saying he needed help getting home.

Thursday, October 15

1:48 p.m. Blair Ave. Report of gas-powered leaf blower. Officer finds person using construction tools.

Friday, October 16

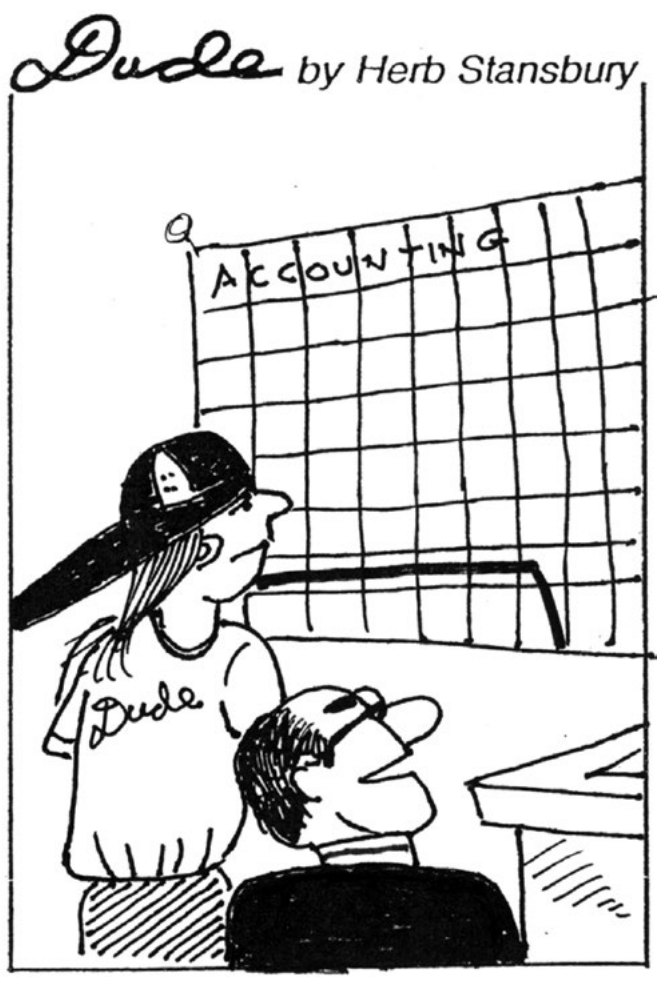
9:48 a.m. Moraga Ave. Report of vehicle unmoved since Sunday. Officer marks black Ford Crown Victoria for tow.

PICK OF THE WEEK

• *Close enough to place a tin can call*

Wednesday, October 14

3:22 p.m. Highland Ave. Juvenile reports a friend took his bike from Mulberry's, another kid also riding on the back at Piedmont Park. Caller calls back to say no police response needed, friend brought bike back.



"We have an accounting problem, Dude. We ran out of money."

Sports

Boys' water polo team tops Lick-Wilmerding



Staff Photos

Piedmont's water polo team prepares for the Western Alameda County Conference Tournament, the postseason precursor to North Coast Section.

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's boys' water polo team gained a 15-8 win over Lick-Wilmerding in San Francisco on Tuesday, October 13. The result improved their record to 10-10 overall and 3-2 against Western Alameda County Conference opponents with one match left in the regular season.



Henry Stein scored seven goals in Piedmont's win over Lick-Wilmerding.

It was a strong offensive day for Piedmont's two leading scorers, Henry Stein and Rylan Patty, with seven and five goals respectively.

The Highlanders played their final regular season game yesterday, October 20, against rival Bishop O'Dowd. With a victory, they will end the season as the WACC's second-ranked team.

They now prepare for the first round of the WACC Tournament on Tuesday, October 27 at Encinal, with the second round on October 29, and finals on Halloween, October 31.

Match Recap

Piedmont led 3-2 through the first quarter and dominated the second quarter to lead 8-4 by halftime. PHS maintained a four-goal lead through the third quarter, 11-7, adding four more goals in the fourth quarter while only conceding one.

In the first, nearly half of the quarter played without a goal until Lick struck first at the 3:46 mark. 50 seconds later, PHS drew a five-meter penalty, leading to Rylan Patty launching in a goal to tie the game. However, the Tigers regained the lead just 11 seconds later on its next possession. It took just 12 seconds for Piedmont to tie it up, once again, at 2:32 when Henry Stein scored. Graham Smith gave PHS the lead with 29 seconds remaining in the first.

Lick tied the match at 3-3 just 19 seconds into the second quarter at 6:41, but that's the closest things would get from then on. The Highlanders drew another five-meter penalty at the 5:22 mark, leading to Stein scoring his second goal. PHS added two more goals by Patty and Stein to lead 6-3 with 3:41 left. Lick scored its fourth at 2:04, leading to two more unanswered goals by Stein to give his team an 8-4 lead with 34 seconds left before halftime.

See Boys' Water Polo on page 28



Girls Tennis splits matches against Alameda & Berkeley

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' tennis team split its last two Western Alameda County Conference matches over the past week. They recently swept Berkeley 7-0 at the Berkeley Tennis Club on Thursday, October 15, but lost 4-3 to Alameda the previous day at the Corey Reich Tennis Center.

The results brings Piedmont's record to 11-5 overall. Te loss to Alameda is their only league defeat at 4-1, putting them behind the Hornets as the regular season winds to a close. PHS will get one more shot at Alameda in the season-finale next week on October 28. A win will mean they can share the WACC title.

"It was really close against Alameda and we had our chances. We look forward to our second match against them, I'm sure it will be another great match," coach Jim Landes said.

Junior Leela Sivakumar had a successful pair of matches against Alameda and Berkeley. She beat Alameda's Natalie Gilbert in straight sets, which avenges two consecutive losses she had to Gilbert.

"Against Alameda, I actually played this girl four times and lost the last two. I was determined going in, and I played a lot over the weekend and did a lot of footwork drills. Being able to be consistent, move my feet, and get to the ball to the right spot is what helped me get there. She has an interesting playing style that threw me off the last times I played her, so I knew she was consistent and switch things up from a huge forehand to a soft slice," Sivakumar said.

7-0 over Berkeley

Piedmont made quick work of the Yellowjackets in its one-sided sweep. Emma Chan and Chiara Silvio started the day with a 6-0, 6-1 win at No. 1 doubles, and was quickly followed by Maddy Huynh winning 6-0, 6-0 at No. 3 singles.

From there, Faith Chin also won by a shutout score of 6-0, 6-0 at No. 2 singles. Clinching the match day was Ella Ruthven at No. 1 singles, winning 6-3, 6-0. Sivakumar then won 6-0, 7-5 at No. 4 singles.

PHS final two wins came at

See Girls' Tennis on page 23



Staff Photos

Leela Sivakumar talks about strategy with assistant coach Corey Reich.



Faith Chin had a 6-0, 6-0 sweep against Berkeley and a narrow three-set loss against Alameda.



Maddy Huynh had wins against Alameda and Berkeley at No. 3 singles.

Highlanders take rough 20-3 loss at Castro Valley



Staff Photos

Piedmont suffered a 20-3 loss at Castro Valley. They look ahead to another league battle at Tennyson next week.

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's football team suffered a disappointing 20-3 loss on the road at Castro Valley on Friday, October 16. The defeat brings their record to 2-5 overall and 1-1 against Western Alameda County Conference Mission Division teams.

The one-sided loss comes at somewhat of a surprise with the Trojans entering the game winless at 0-7, while the Highlanders were coming off an impressive 35-20 victory over Arroyo the previous week. PHS was notably without starting running back Rehan Mumtaz.

Piedmont looks ahead to division-leading Tennyson in Hayward on Friday, October 23. The Lancers are 6-2 overall and are 2-0 in league after beating Alameda 39-8.

At 2-5, PHS can still qualify for North Coast Section by winning its final three games or finishing its league schedule with an even .500 record.

Game Recap

Castro Valley drove down to Piedmont's 15 in its first drive of the game, but John Bunje recorded a big tackle for loss on fourth down. However, PHS tossed an interception on their very first play, giving the Trojans possession at the 14. CV followed up by scoring on six plays with a one-yard punch, going up 7-0.

Piedmont scored its only points on the next drive after starting on their own 20. It featured Cyrus Emanuelson converting a 3rd-and-5 from their 25 with a scramble, while Emanuelson also converted a 4th-and-5 on a pass to Max Fujimoto. The series stalled out at Castro Valley's 12, leading to Ben Gerber kicking a 29-yard field goal early in the second quarter, making it 7-3.

But that was it from the Highlanders. Castro Valley scored on an eight-play, 80-yard series to give itself a 14-3 lead, which included a 37 yard completion on 3rd-and-7, and a 25-yard carry on 1st-and-20 following a holding penalty.

PHS drove to the CV 30 on its next possession, but a sack-fumble led to the Trojans regaining possession at the Piedmont 21. A 29-yard field goal of their own gave CV a 17-3 advantage.

The Trojans then made a 28-yard field goal to make it 20-3 midway through the third quarter. Both teams went scoreless for remainder of the second half. Bunje blocked a field goal late in the third quarter, leading to PHS assuming possession at their 39, but the drive stalled at CV's 31 early in the fourth. The Trojans were able to run out the clock from there.

Final stats: Cyrus Emanuelson completed 11 of 18 passes for 123 yards. Mason Gray had seven receptions for 70 yards. Fujimoto had two receptions for 25 yards. Vaha Mafi had nine carries for 25 yards, along with one reception for 16 yards.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (2-5 overall, 1-1 league) visits Tennyson in Hayward on Friday, October 23 at 7:00 p.m.



John Bunje blocked a field goal against Castro Valley.



Max Fujimoto had two receptions for 25 yards.

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Girls Volleyball falls 3-1 to Berkeley



Photos

Girls Volleyball approaches their final two matches of the regular season.

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' volleyball team suffered a 3-1 loss to Berkeley at the Yellowjackets' gym on Wednesday, October 14. The result brings the Highlanders' record to 14-11 overall and 3-5 against Western Alameda County Conference competition with two matches left in their regular season.

PHS will host Alameda for the season-finale on Thursday, October 22 and look ahead to their second consecutive North Coast Section appearance on October 28-29.

"We're working on little things and having better judgment on what we call Yellow Light sets, which is a set that isn't there to be put down and be a little more careful to keep it in play. On our defensive switches, we want to be on the same page," co-head coach Mike Glass said regarding final things to tune up before NCS.

"We just need to move things a little bit faster. Just owning that on the court will help us," mentioned team captain Allyson Hyunh.

Maxpreps.com currently has the Highlanders as NCS' No. 41 ranked school, which would put them on pace for a Division 3 berth and a No. 4 seed. Should Piedmont earn a top-eight seed, they'll be set to host a second consecutive postseason match after receiving the No. 8 ranking in the D4 bracket last year.

Match Recap

Piedmont fell by scores of 25-18, 25-14, 23-25, 25-21.

In the first set, Berkeley scored the first four points and led 6-2 before PHS battled to a 6-6 tie that included two blocks by freshman Charlotte Bailey. Piedmont rallied to tie again at 9-9 with a block and kill by Bailey, and then tied again at 10-10, 11-11, and 12-12 after two Berkeley errors and a kill by sophomore Emilia Angulo. However, the Jackets scored the next eight of nine points to take a commanding 20-13 lead. PHS inched to 23-18, but BHS scored the final two points to win.

The second set started similarly with Berkeley taking the first five points. PHS scored three straight to make it 5-3 with kills by Olivia Stevens and Izara Dando, but Berkeley then landed 10 straight points. Piedmont scored five straight to cut the lead in half to 15-8 after a string of errors and a kill by Maika Ting. Berkeley then established a 20-8 lead, leading to PHS scoring on two kills by Ting and an ace by Huynh, now 20-13. But after that, Berkeley finished the set scoring five of the final six points.

Piedmont's third-set win started with Berkeley holding a 5-3 lead. PHS then gained a 10-7 lead with kills by Ting and Fiona Olsen, and extended to 16-10 with two kills by Sofia Meyer and an ace by Sarina Hill. The two sides traded points until the Highlanders led 24-19. Berkeley pulled within one point at 24-23, but PHS won the set with a kill by Dando.

PHS was in good position in the fourth set, holding an 11-6 lead after scoring five straight points with a kill by Bailey, an ace by Hill, and blocks by Nora Trombi and Angulo. But with Piedmont up 15-11, Berkeley went on an 8-1 scoring run to take a 19-16 lead. The Highlanders cut the deficit to one at 22-21 after a kill by Angulo, but Berkeley scored the final three points to win 25-21.

Final stats: Ting had eight kills, two blocks and four digs. Bailey had six kills, eight blocks. Dando had four kills and one block. Meyer had three kills. Trombi had three kills, four blocks. Stevens had two kills and nine digs. Lucia Dorsey had five kills, four blocks. Angulo had three kills, two blocks. Huynh had one ace, nine digs and three assists. Corina Vora had eight digs and 20 assists. Mia Bechtel had four digs and 12 assists. Hill had two aces.

Tuesday vs. Castro Valley

Piedmont visited Castro Valley on Tuesday, October 20. See next week's *Post* for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (14-11 overall, 3-5 league) hosts Alameda on Thursday, October 22 at 6:30 p.m.



Charlotte Bailey had six kills and eight blocks against Berkeley.

JV Highlanders beat Castro Valley 22-8

By Demetri Adams

The JV Piedmont Highlanders football team claimed a 22-8 victory over the Castro Valley Trojans in an away game on Friday, October 16th. Head Coach Pouyan Assadi said "It was our most complete game on offense" to the Highlanders in the locker room after the game.

The game started with Will Dietrick returning the opening kickoff to the Trojans' 43 yard line, starting the Highlanders off with prime field position. Quarterback and outside linebacker Ernie Hildreth then aided the hot start by claiming a running for a 30 yard QB keeper to the outside to put the Highlanders on the 13 yard line on just the second play of the game. The Highlanders were then able to punch it in with a pass to tight end Mateo Morgan.

Throughout the game, the Highlanders defense only allowed one touchdown and a two-point conversion, making the Trojans look absolutely defeated after the first drive. The Highlanders defense forced five turnovers and kept the Trojans on their back foot the whole game. Keliti Havea racked up 15 tackles with two tackles for loss, and one interception at middle linebacker.

On the Highlanders' second drive wide receiver Lev Kuluva had a 30 yard reverse to put Piedmont in Trojans territory. The drive stalled after the Trojans grabbed an interception after Hildreth was hit while throwing.

A couple of drives later, Dietrick was able to pick off a Castro Valley pass and return it to the two-yard line, allowing Hildreth to score for the Highlanders. Aaron Bornstein then made another Highlander interception to send the teams into the half.



Photos by Graham Smith

Piedmont's JV football team came away with a big 22-8 win over Castro Valley.

In the second half, Kuluva scored a 25-yard receiving touchdown from a great pass by Hildreth on a stop and go route. It marked Kuluva's second touchdown on the season.

Morgan received the "I Got that Dawg In Me" chain from Coach P after the game with his great performance of an interception, and a fumble recovery.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (4-3 overall) travels to Hayward High on Friday, October 23 for a game at 4:00 p.m.



Highlanders celebrate the win over Castro Valley.

PIEDMONT SPORTS SCHEDULE

Some events subject to change. (Revised - 10/21/26)

Date	Day	Sport	Opponent	Loc.	Var.	JV.
Oct. 21	Wed.	XC	Mid-Season Mania Invitational at Campolindo, Moraga	A	3:00	3:00
Oct. 22	Thurs.	FF	WACC Tournament	TBD	TBD	------
		TEN	Castro Valley	H/A	3:30	3:30
		VB	Alameda	H	6:30	5:30
Oct. 23	Fri.	FB	Tennyson (Hayward)	A	7:00	4:00
Oct. 24	Sat.	FF	WACC Finals	TBD	TBD	------
		XC	Haystack Tune-Up at Hayward HS	A	8:30	8:30
Oct. 27	Tues.	WP-B	WACC Tournament at Encinal, Alameda	A	TBD	------
		VB	North Coast Section	TBD	TBD	------
Oct. 28	Wed.	TEN	Alameda	A/H	3:30	3:30
		XC	WACC Meet at Oyster Bay, San Leandro	A	3:30	3:30

KEY: H = Home, A = Away, XC = Cross Country, FB = Football, FF = Flag Football, VB = Girls' Volleyball, WP-B = Boys' Water Polo, TEN = Girls' Tennis, GG = Girls' Golf

Flag Football falls to O'Dowd in season-finale



Staff Photos

Piedmont goes into their league tournament with a 9-10 overall record and 8-6 league record, meaning they have clinched the team's first NCS birth in school history.

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's flag football team suffered a 31-6 loss to Bishop O'Dowd on Thursday, October 15 at Witter Field for its regular season finale. It brings their record to 9-10 overall and 8-6 against Western Alameda County Conference teams as they enter the league tournament.

Piedmont held a 6-6 tie through much of the first half, but the Dragons finished the game with 25 unanswered points, including 19 of them in the second half. The game provides a lesson in finishing for the Highlanders after allowing a touchdown on the final play of the first half, while the Highlanders' offense had multiple drives end on O'Dowd's side of the field.

"We might see O'Dowd next Thursday [in the WACC Tournament]. Now they've seen how they play and know how to react. The attitude has coalesced, and there's a unified drive to them. The lesson is it's not all the defense's job, the offense has to finish. They have the drive to do it, but there's the follow and the finish. They have the follow, now we have to finish," coach Beth Black said.

Regardless of the result, Piedmont's league record going into the WACC Tournament means they have automatically clinched a spot in the North Coast Section playoffs for the first time.

"The next week is now lined up for them. It's a first, and that's something very special for this group," Black said.

Piedmont honored its 11 seniors on the roster, including Kaylani Despanie, Jo Palsa, Ellie Olsen, Naiya Alexander, Anjali Bowers, Brynne Jones, Kate Tong, Agatha Filha Gama, Bea Nackley, Skye Prata Baack, and Carmela DiLauro.

For Tong, she is a two-year member of the varsity squad, watching them improve from 5-13 last season to achieve the school's first-ever NCS berth.

"It's super exciting, it's another week or two playing flag football. It's my senior year, so I'm taking advantage of all the time I can get. It's special to qualify and we deserve it. I'm really proud how we've played," Tong said.

Game Recap

Both teams went scoreless through the first quarter, including Piedmont's defense forcing two turnovers on downs. O'Dowd

See Flag Football on page 23



Nea Mafi scored Piedmont's touchdown against Bishop O'Dowd and also logged an interception.



Kate Tong is a three-year varsity starter and member of the 2027 senior class.

HIKING WITH JON

Fall colors at Mt. Tamalpais' Dawn Falls to Barbara Springs trails

By Jonathan Comeaux

Mt. Tamalpais has well over 100 miles of trails to hike; from the steep and strenuous, to the relaxed and nature focused. For this venture, we walk 1.5 miles on the Dawn Falls Trail to the Southern Marin Line Fire Road until reaching the Barbara Springs Trail and back to the car, making an easy but stunning 3.5 mile hike.

Its Dawn Falls Trail is a short and popular 1.4 mile walk with over 510 feet in elevation gain to its main attraction, Dawn Falls. Although the "Falls" is more of a trickle given its only active during or after a heavy rain, the walk shows you what makes Mt. Tam so magnificent.

At times, you will pass through narrow corridors of redwood trees that look something out of a fairytale with steam raising off it during the morning hours.

Starting at the Dawn Falls Trailhead on Madrone Avenue in Larkspur, the trail along the inactive Larkspur Creek is a palette of vibrant fall colors from maple leaves; redwoods tower over in every direction, while lush green moss covers every tree, stone, and branch.

It is worth mentioning that the Dawn Falls Trail is a mostly slim passage of under three-feet wide—meaning you will have to be patient when passing by hikers, runners, and an inevitable number of groups during weekends. Our 10 a.m. walk up to the falls passed a staggering 49 people in the 1.5 miles, passing another 34 people in the remaining two miles back to the car—making 83 people passed in total, so near 24 other patrons per mile.

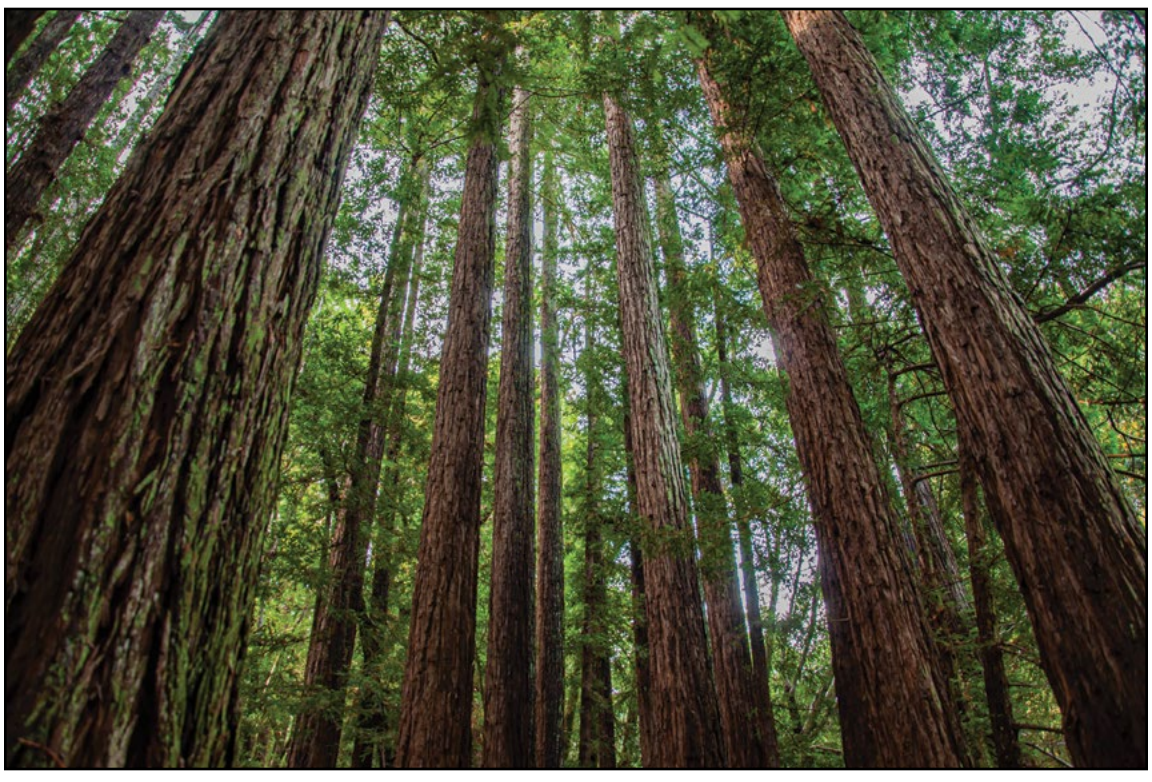
For those conscious of personal space, continue on the Southern Marin Line Fire Road; a dirt road which is wide enough to adequate two lanes of cars. Otherwise, you can continue up the Hoo Koo E Koo Trail and Blithedale Ridge trails, which will more than double your elevation gain to provide a workout of near 1,200 feet until re-intersecting with the fire road.

You'll get glimpses of Mt. Tam's eastern peak from the fire road. The 0.5 mile walk down the Barbara Springs Trail back to the car is a very steep 500-foot descent with tree roots , n every direction, so be wary. You'll likely have to use your hands if you don't have hiking sticks.

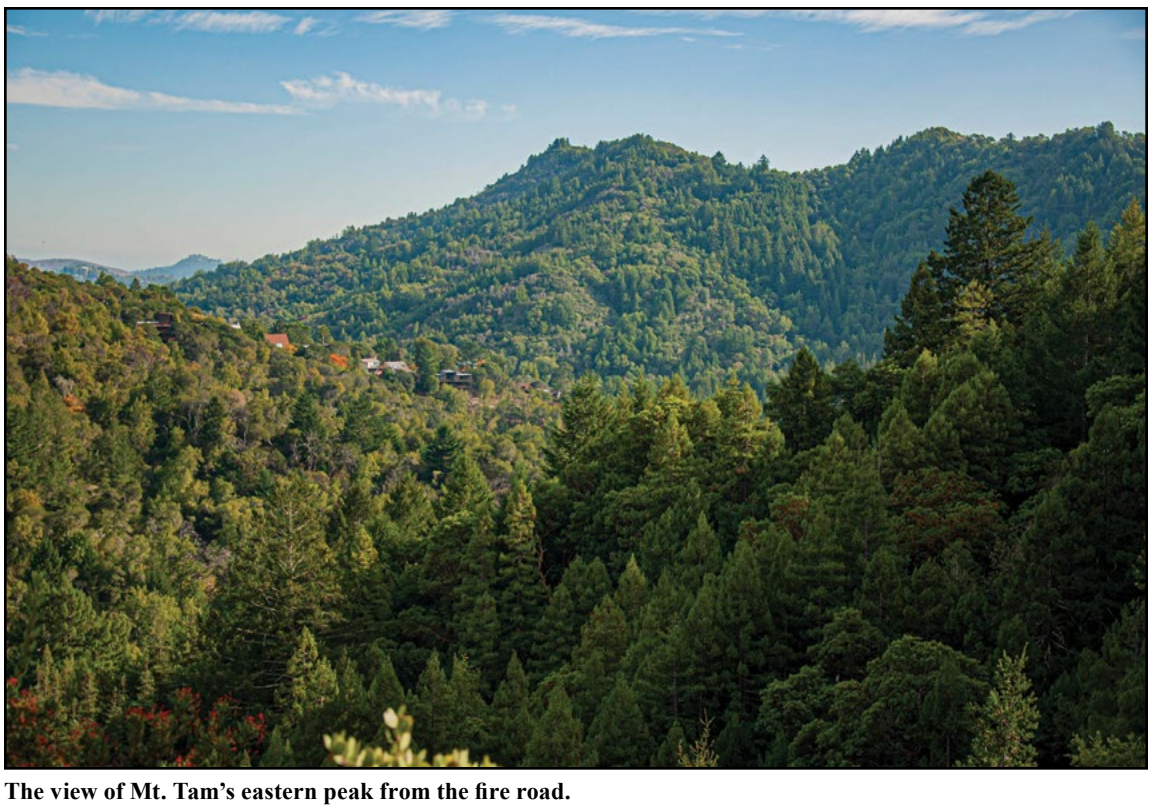


Staff Photos

A narrow corridor of redwood trees is shown along the Dawn Falls Trail on Mt. Tamalpais.



Redwoods tower overhead in every direction.



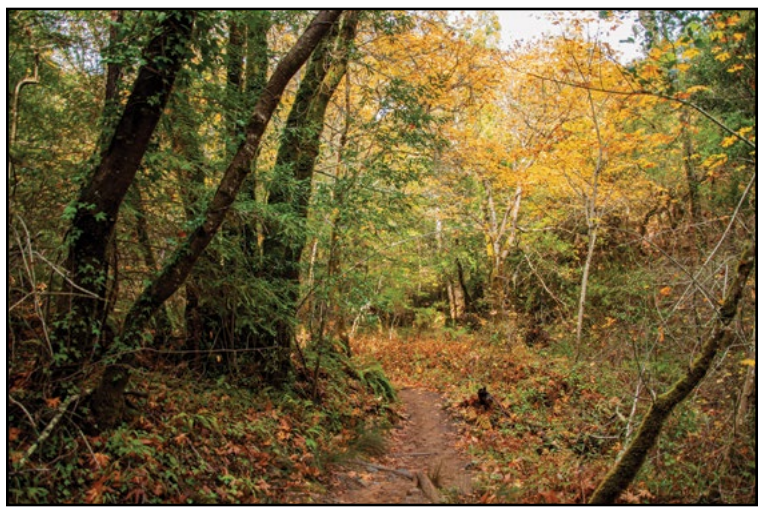
The view of Mt. Tam's eastern peak from the fire road.



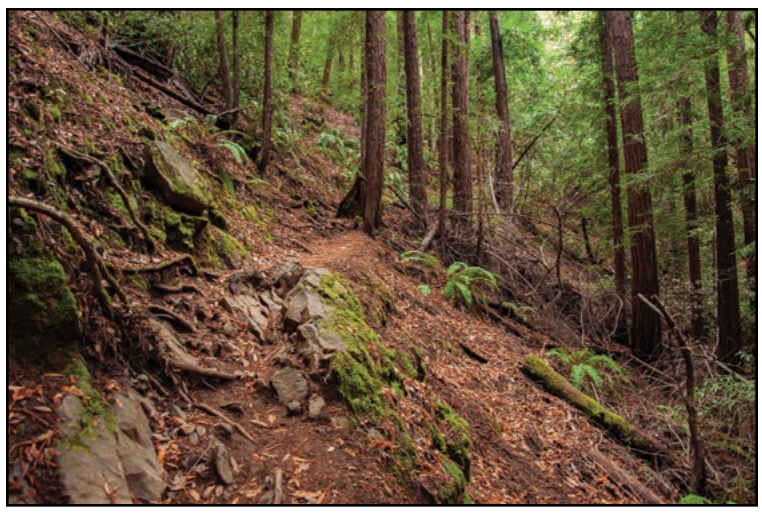
The Dawn Falls Trail leads to its main attraction, Dawn Falls — which is only active during or right after a heavy rain.



Moss is a main feature of this trail. Each stone, log, and tree is covered in lush moss.



The fall colors are everywhere on Mt. Tamalpais.



Be mindful that the trail is typically less than 3-feet wide.

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Piedmont Avenue HALLOWEEN CELEBRATION



Piedmont Ave. Halloween Celebration: A very sweet tradition

By Paisley Strellis

The Piedmont Avenue Halloween Parade was started in 1987 by a number of Piedmont Avenue merchants who "wanted to give kids a safe place to trick-or-treat," recalled the late Richard Stone, owner of Continental Hearing. In its early years, Stone says just two or three blocks of the street were closed to traffic for an afternoon and kids were invited to wear their costumes and trick-or-treat at various participating merchants.

Stone, who was a member of the Lions Club, used the opportunity to raise money for Children's Hospital and the Lions Center for the Blind in Oakland.

"We sold all-beef hot dogs for a dollar and gave the proceeds to those charities," he said.

The Lions Club also gave big carving pumpkins to children, but after a few years, they found that they were giving out thousands of pumpkins.

"It's been exciting to see the Halloween Celebration grow from this tiny thing into something huge," said Stone, who was in business on Piedmont Avenue for more than 40 years. "Now you see not just kids, but moms and dads and dogs, with everyone all dressed up. It is a lot of fun," he said.

Another fan of the event is Piedmont Grocery's Dave Larson, a longtime merchant on Piedmont Avenue and Grand Marshal of the Parade a couple times in recent years. "I had a wonderful time, mostly scaring children," joked Larson, who one year dressed in tails, a top

See Halloween Parade on page 15



Fenton's bicycle cart will follow the brass band in the Piedmont Avenue Halloween Parade.

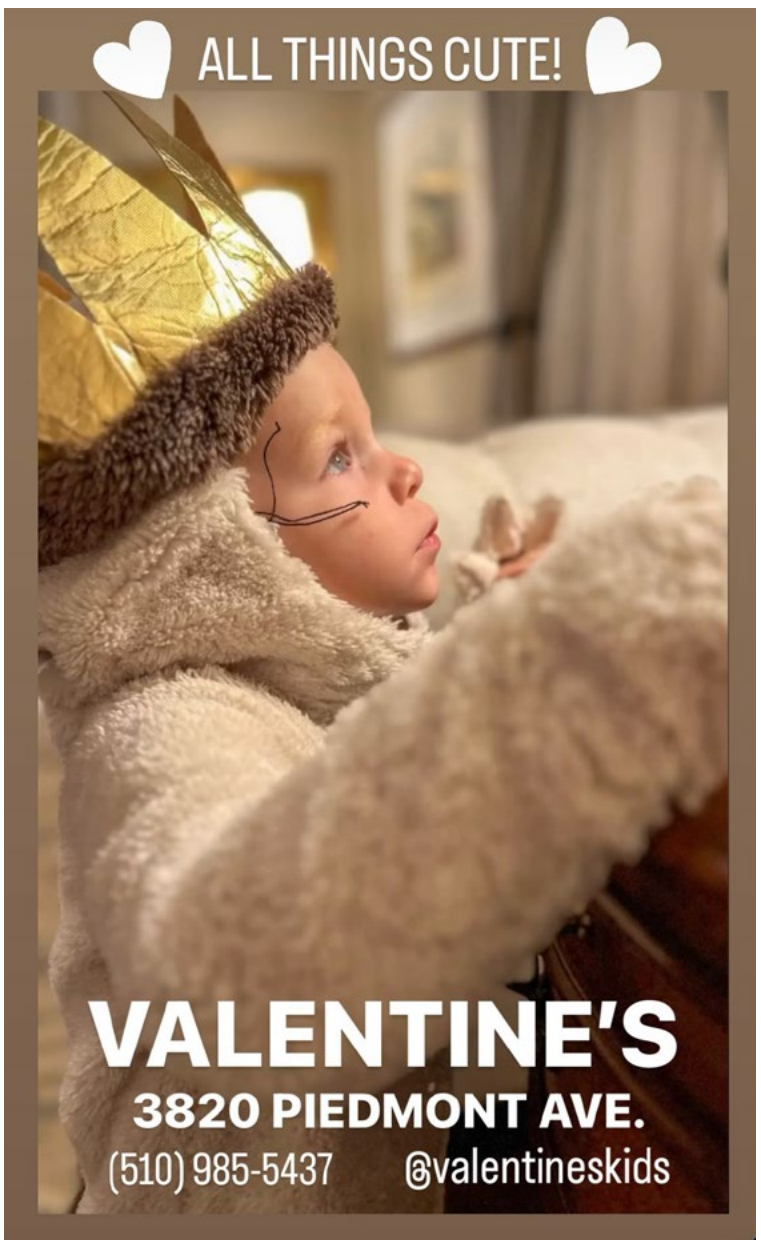
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Piedmont Avenue #HALLOWEEN CELEBRATION

Halloween Parade

Continued from page 14

hat, a sash and a monster mask to lead the parade. "I think this event is a great thing for Piedmont Avenue and a great way to connect with the community," said Larson. He finds the parade to be a fun time, knowing it has been part of the Avenue for such a long time.

There will be some changes to the parade this year. The Orchestra Euphonos will be heading up the annual parade. The group has been a Bay Area Klezmer and brass band for 13 years. And behind the brass band will be the Fenton's bicycle cart strewn with festive decorations. But the pièce de résistance is this year's Grand Marshal, Sacha Desousa, the owner of Valentine's. The children's store has been on the Avenue for 12-and-a-half years and counting! You will recognize Sacha dressed as the White Rabbit from Alice in Wonderland, walking the route and throwing out candy.

Following the parade, Mountain View Cemetery will hold its 18th annual Pumpkin Festival which will continue from noon to 3 p.m. The festival will include pumpkins, activities, and treats for the kids. The festival will also feature several bouncy houses to jump around in, a live animal show, a clown balloon artist, face painting, and a craft area to decorate pumpkins, masks, and treat bags. Food truck will be on site with food for purchase.

Parents must accompany their children to this free event.

For more information, visit piedmontavenue.org or mountainviewcemetery.org/pumpkin.html

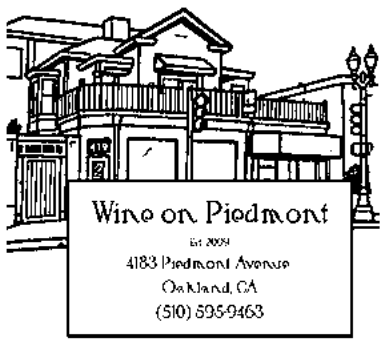


Orchestra Euphonos will head up the Parade kick off this year.

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Arts & Entertainment

Photographing the City of Light now on view at Legion of Honor

By Allyson Aleksey

An exhibition at the Legion of Honor in San Francisco explores how photographers helped shape the image of Paris through photographs documenting the city's architecture, cultural heritage and transformation into a modern metropolis.

Eternal Paris: Photographing the City of Light is on view now, featuring nearly 50 photographs from the Achenbach Foundation for Graphic Arts, many of which have never been exhibited publicly.

The exhibition traces the work of photographers in the 19th and early 20th centuries who documented Paris' historic landmarks, preserved its architectural heritage and captured the changes that reshaped the city. Their images helped establish Paris as an international center of art and culture.

Among the works are early photographs of the city's celebrated monuments, images of the ruins left by the Paris Commune of 1871 and photographs documenting Paris as it stood on the threshold of modernity.

The exhibition also features works by photographers including Édouard-Denis Baldus, Eugène Atget and Brassaï. Atget is known for his extensive photographic documentation of Paris, recording its streets, buildings and neighborhoods during a period of significant urban change.

Together, the photographs show how the medium helped preserve the city's past while documenting its evolution. They also reveal how photographers contributed to the romanticized image of Paris that continues to influence how the city is viewed today.

Eternal Paris: Photographing the City of Light is on view at the Legion of Honor, 100 34th Ave. in San Francisco, through February 28, 2027.

For information, visit famsf.org/exhibitions/eternal-paris-photographing-city-light.



Photo courtesy of Legion of Honor

Louis-Gabriel Loppé (French, 1825–1913), *Vue de la Tour Eiffel et de la Grande Roue*

Oakland Ballet's *Luna Mexicana* showing Oct. 30 & Nov. 1

By Allyson Aleksey

Oakland Ballet Company performs *Luna Mexicana*, a ballet celebrating Día de los Muertos and traditional Mexican dance, on October 30 and November 1 at the Paramount Theatre in Oakland.

Luna Mexicana is an original work by Oakland Ballet Company's Artistic Director Graham Lustig and is one of the Bay Area's most celebrated events honoring Día de los Muertos, or Day of the Dead, a holiday celebrated and observed mostly in Mexico and Latin America.

Lustig's production features a young woman whose ancestors "dance" back to life in the form of teetering skeletons, skirt-swishing ladies and a bride and groom duet. In 2018, Oakland Ballet Company premiered *Viva la Vida*, co-choreographed by Lustig and Martín Romero of Ballet Folklorico Mexico Danza. The dance celebrates the life and artistry of iconic Mexican artist Frida Kahlo, and is now included in annual presentations of *Luna Mexicana*.

The program is presented in two acts with an intermission, and features a selection of Mexican contemporary and folkloric dance as well as music curated by Lustig. Past performances have included the Aztec ensemble Nahui-Ehekatl and Co. and dancers from Ballet Folklorico Mexico Danza.



Photo courtesy of Oakland Ballet

Oakland Ballet's *Luna Mexicana* is showing at the Paramount Theatre Oct. 30 and Nov. 1

Audience members of all ages are encouraged to attend in Day of the Dead costume. Luna Mexicana is a family-friendly event and ideal for audience members ages 7 and up.

Tickets are available online now. Visit https://oaklandballet.org to purchase tickets.

Randall Museum hosts "Family Halloween Day" this Saturday

By Allyson Aleksey

Celebrate Halloween a week early at Randall Museum in San Francisco.

The museum is hosting a "Family Halloween Day" this Saturday, October 24, from 10 a.m. to 2 p.m. Come in costume and participate in an array of fun family activities, including ghoulish games, creepy crafts, tricks and treats, costume awards, live music, entertainment in the theater and more. Admission is free.

Young attendees will also enjoy guest entertainer Bri Crabtree's Silly Circus. Bri Crabtree has over 20 years of experience in children's entertainment and is professionally trained in juggling, unicycling, magic, mime, dance, and clowning. She is based in Oakland.

The Randall Museum is operated by the San Francisco Recreation and Parks Department and the non-profit organization Randall Museum Friends. The family-friendly space provides a unique experience for Bay Area kids of all ages, offering science, engineering, biology and art workshops throughout the year.

Visit https://randallmuseum.org/events/family-halloween-2026/ for more information.



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READ IT IN THE *POST*

Peter Pan Goes Wrong playing at SF Playhouse now through Nov. 28



Scene from *Peter Pan Goes Wrong* *Photo courtesy of San Francisco Playhouse*

By Allyson Aleksey

San Francisco Playhouse is presenting *Peter Pan Goes Wrong*, a comedy about an amateur theater company attempting to stage *Peter Pan* while a series of mishaps threatens to derail the production.

Written by Henry Lewis, Henry Shields and Jonathan Sayer, the play follows the fictional Cornley Polytechnic Drama Society as its members take on J.M. Barrie's classic story. The production features flying rigs, sword fights and a crocodile, along with forgotten lines, malfunctioning scenery and rivalries that spill onto the stage.

The play is by the creators of *The Play That Goes Wrong*, which similarly follows a fictional theater troupe whose production goes increasingly awry. *Peter Pan Goes Wrong* premiered in London in 2013 before later moving to the West End and Broadway.

Susi Damilano directs the San Francisco production. The cast includes Greg Ayers, Joe Ayers, Maggie Mason, Christian McCooey, Ezra Reaves, Renee Rogoff, Patrick Russell, Sophie Schulman, Terrance Austin Smith, Jomar Tagatac and Phaedra Tillery-Boughton, among others.

The production runs through November 28 at San Francisco Playhouse, 450 Post St. in San Francisco's Union Square neighborhood. Performances are Tuesday through Sunday, with evening and matinee performances on select days. The show runs approximately two hours and five minutes, including a 15-minute intermission, and is recommended for ages 8 and older.

Visit https://sfplayhouse.org/2026-2027-season/peter-pan-goes-wrong/ to purchase tickets online.

Shotgun Players extends *The Fall Show* through Nov. 1

By Allyson Aleksey

Shotgun Players presents a surreal romance story of older love based on the works of playwright Charles Mee, directed and choreographed by Erika Chong Shuch.

The Fall Show features main characters Eddie and Sam, who are joined by a six-person ensemble that serves to disrupt and evoke the ups and downs of falling in love.

Mee was an American playwright, historian and author known for experimental plays that combined classical literature, historical texts, popular culture and contemporary themes.

His best-known plays include *Big Love*, a contemporary adaptation of the Greek tragedy *The Suppliants; bobrauschenbergamerica*, inspired by the collage art of Robert Rauschenberg; *Orestes 2.0* and *The Trojan Women: A Love Story*, modern adaptations of Greek tragedies; and *Hotel Cassiopeia*, about artist Joseph Cornell.

In a press release, director Shuch said she and dramaturg Sarah Rose Leonard "combed the expanse of Charles Mee's corpus of plays for a story that resonated."

"I've been thinking about how the love stories of middle-aged and older adults—and I include myself in this category—are muted. Falling in love, being in love, maintaining love: it's complicated, twisty, chaotic," said Shuch. "I hope I continue to be baffled by how to love, because it means I'm still thinking about it, still trying for it, still rooting for it, still valuing it."

Tickets are available for purchase at www.shotgunplayers.org/show/fall/ or by calling the box office: 510-841-6500 x 303.



Scene from *The Fall Show* *Photo courtesy of Shotgun Players*

San Francisco Opera presents Mozart's *The Marriage of Figaro*

Opera performed Oct. 31 through Nov. 29

By Allyson Aleksey

San Francisco Opera will present Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart's *The Marriage of Figaro* October 31 through November 29 at the War Memorial Opera House.

The production, directed by the late Michael Cavanagh, returns to the company following its 2019 debut. Shawna Lucey directs the revival, and conductor Sebastian Weigle makes his San Francisco Opera debut leading the orchestra and cast.

The opera premiered in Vienna in 1786 and was the first of three collaborations between Mozart and librettist Lorenzo Da Ponte, followed by *Don Giovanni* in 1787 and *Così fan tutte* in 1790. Based on a French play by Pierre Beaumarchais, the comic opera explores class divisions through the story of Figaro and Susanna as they prepare to marry.

Cavanagh's production sets the story in an American manor house during Mozart's time. It was the first installment of San Francisco Opera's planned Mozart-Da Ponte trilogy.

Slovak bass Peter Kellner makes his company debut in the title role, with Slovak soprano Slávka Zámečníková as Susanna. The cast also includes Canadian soprano Olivia Smith as Countess Almaviva, mezzo-soprano Simone McIntosh as Cherubino and British baritone Thomas Mole as Count Almaviva.

The opera will be performed in Italian with English supertitles.



Conductor Sebastian Weigle

San Francisco Opera dramaturg emeritus Clifford "Kip" Cranna will give a 20-minute pre-opera talk 55 minutes before each performance.

The November 7 performance at 7:30 p.m. will be livestreamed, with on-demand viewing available for 48 hours beginning November 8 at 10 a.m. Livestream tickets cost $25.

Performances are scheduled for Oct. 31; Nov. 3, 7, 10, 13, 15, 18, 21, 27 and 29. Evening performances begin at 7:30 p.m., and matinees begin at 2 p.m.

The War Memorial Opera House is at 301 Van Ness Ave. in San Francisco. For tickets and information, call the box office at (415) 864-3330 or visit sfopera.com.

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The Musical Gourmet

Hear and There

By Joseph Gold

It's good to be home. While we were in Europe, we had the opportunity to hear a number of concerts. And then as soon as we returned, we heard concerts in this area. Comparing the philosophy of these concerts presents profound thoughts.

First and foremost, concerts are entertainment.

A few things come to mind. The repertoire must be as well thought out as an excellent meal is presented to a gourmet. Punctuality shows respect for the audience. The same goes for concert dress. I like to have a printed program but that is a rarity these days. Having a printed program helps to prevent a performer from yapping unintelligibly.

The audience, too, has a responsibility. It should behave itself appropriately. Does a mediocre performance deserve a standing ovation? Should the audience show its approval by applauding or should it hoot, howl and bark to show its approval?

Concerts on Saturday and Sunday offered answers to these questions.

Saturday's evening concert in the Piedmont Center for the Arts was entitled "Land's End folk ensemble concert." This particular concert centered around tenor Chris Oglesby. Although there was no printed program, it was my impression that Oglesby had conceived the program. All in all, it was a concert centering around American folk traditions. Oglesby is a fine tenor singer and presents a charming personality on stage. His program featured a comprehensive look at American folk literature presented in a high-level concert structure.

Compliments are due for these things. Oglesby has a high-quality voice, and he sings in a convincing manner. All of this was very enjoyable. What was distressing was to hear his endless spoken introductions to every song group. To tell you the truth, I understood nothing. I spoke to Oglesby during intermission and I told him that I couldn't understand a word that he said. He responded by saying that when he is in performance mode, he speaks too fast. I suggested that he should listen to some of the fine singers of the past who "improvised" spoken introductions. I mentioned the likes of singers John McCormack and John Charles Thomas and violinist Jascha Heifetz.

Public speakers need to learn three things. They are:

1) Know what you're going to say before you begin.
2) Be brief
3) Speak clearly. Remember that there are consonants as well as vowels. And speak in a resonant voice.

It's also good to speak as if you had a prepared script.



Composer and librettist Claudia Stevens and Alan Shearer after the premiere of their opera, *Leaving the White House*

Berkeley Piano Club

A concert on Sunday afternoon at the Berkeley Piano Club featured "modern music." I received a personal invitation from composer Claudia Stevens and was delighted to attend.

This particular program centered around human emotions which come full circle over a span of 72 years. Musically speaking, many aspects of history were brought to life. Political observations opened the program with a *sprechstimme* version of what happened at the Great Flint Michigan auto workers' strike of 1937. Then composer Ann Callaway played the piano in the premiere of her "Harmonic Sounds" Concerto for a 12-string fretless electronic bass and small string ensemble. The unique instrumentation and format were nonetheless an opportunity for ample virtuosity.

After intermission came a solo cello composition by Elliott Carter, entitled "Figment II (remembering Mr. Ives)." I took the opportunity to look at the score and was absolutely terrified by its immense difficulties. My impression of the composition is that the composer harbored animosity toward the person for whom it was composed.

Concluding the program was a brief two-part opera by composers Alan Shearer and Claudia Stevens. History has informed us of the assassination of Abraham Lincoln and the train which delivered his body to the funeral.

We rarely hear of the sadness endured by Lincoln's widow and his son, Robert Lincoln. The story is a very sad one… a very sad one indeed. Musically, the brief opera was a story for the ages. Thank you very much, Claudia Stevens, for the invitation and your artistry.

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***Oakland Art Association* gallery show**

Oakland Art Association presents *"Hopes and Dreams"* — a curated show. OAA is a non-profit group of artists, photographers, and art supporters in Alameda and Contra Costa Counties whose mission is to encourage artistic endeavor in the community, support public school art education, and arrange show venues. Free and open to all. For more information, see www.oaklandart.org. Gallery is open and staffed Saturdays and Sundays from 11 am to 2 pm.

Sunday, October 25, 4:00 p.m.

Festival Opera Salon 2 – "Mad Scenes"

Acclaimed sopranos **Aura Veruni** and **Lila Khazoum** are joined by pianist **Daniel Lockert** to perform diabolical scenes from *Idomeneo*, *Macbeth*, *The Magic Flute*, *Anna Bolena*, *Hamlet*, and *Lucia di Lammermoor*; with costumes by designer Marina Polakoff and props to help with the storytelling. This concert will lean into the macabre and unhinged elements of opera, just in time for Halloween. Come in costume if you like, and witness all of opera's great mad scenes in one evening. Advance tickets are at https://tinyurl.com/FestivalSalon2

Friday, November 6, 5:00–8:00 p.m.

Artist's Opening Reception

Artist/Art Historian **Michael Stehr** returns to Piedmont Center for the Arts with a new collection of paintings inspired by a recent Fall trip to Japan: *Falling for the Rising Sun*. The twelve-day adventure provided Michael with a new type of inspiration: totally new architectural silhouettes, blasts of vivid color, and a sea of friendly faces. This year's exhibit will include 28 new paintings of Japan, Rome, and Paris. A number of the new pictures boast a larger scale than what is customary in Michael's body of work. This exhibit will have open gallery hours on Saturdays and Sundays from 11 a.m. to 2 p.m. through November 29.

Saturday, November 7, 3:30 p.m.

Stravinsky and Rachmaninoff

Solo and Duet Piano works by two singular world-famous Russian composers will be performed by a rotating assortment of pianists and will be presented in two sets with a brief intermission. The concert begins at 3:30 pm, with the second set starting at 4:30 pm. The six performers come mostly from the San Francisco Bay Area. Many of them have competed in prestigious international competitions for amateur pianists and many are top prize winners. The event's producer, renowned Bay Area pianist and piano educator **Dr. Gwendolyn Mok**, will present the net proceeds from this fundraising event to a major international charity, as she did last year after a sold-out similar event featuring the complete solo piano works of Maurice Ravel. Advance tickets are available now at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Mokpiano.

Sunday, November 8, 4:00 p.m.

Piedmont Chamber Orchestra

Piedmont's volunteer orchestra presents an afternoon of rarely performed musical gems by Louise Farrenc, Béla Bartók and George Enescu. The program, called *Portraits & Poetry: Musical Gems for Winds and Strings*, features Bartók's *Dances of Transylvania*, Enescu's *Dixtour for Double Wind Quintet*, and Louise Farrenc's *Symphony No. 3*. Get your tickets early. This popular Piedmont ensemble fills the house quickly. Reserve your seats now on Eventbrite at https://www.eventbrite.com/e/2002984140483

Wednesday, November 11, 7:00 p.m.

***Trio Solano* Bach Concert**

Founded during the pandemic shutdown in 2020, **Trio Solano** performs traditional and new string trio repertoire throughout the S. F. Bay Area. The Trio received a grant from InterMusic SF in 2021, a Silver Medal from Global Music Awards in 2022, and frequently teams up with pianist Miles Graber. **Dan Flanagan** is a founding member of Trio Solano, an award-winning ensemble dedicated to both traditional repertoire and contemporary works. As Concertmaster of the Sacramento Philharmonic and Opera and Instructor of Violin at UC Berkeley, he brings profound musical insight to the trio's performances throughout the Bay Area. His versatility as both performer and composer enriches the ensemble's programming. His experience with the Eco Ensemble and collaborations with artists such as Leon Fleisher inform his innovative approach to chamber music. Flanagan performs on an historic 1840 JB Vuillaume violin, contributing to the trio's distinctive musical voice. Advance tickets can be found at https://www.ticketsignup.io/TrioSol.

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SERIES REVIEW

Netflix should axe Ian Brennan for *Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story*

By Britton McCormick

A Netflix series created by Ian Brennan and Ryan Murphy called *Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story* should be avoided by everyone with a pulse. The creators use mostly fabricated half truths and the "facts" used favor the sensational over reality.

This season, the fourth in the *Monster* anthology true crime series, looks to explore misogyny, sexism, sexual identity, and how society has viewed women through the centuries. Watchers who want to explore those themes will be disappointed by the purposeful misrepresentation of all of the real-life people and how it harms the experiences of real people.

Borden did not face many of the issues she is depicted as having in the show. Lizzie and her sister were paid $5,000, the equivalent of $173,000 in 2026, by their father for a property that they purchased from him for $1. Brennan uses Lizzie Borden as a stand-in for the issues women in high-society faced during Victorian era Massachusetts. Unlike in the show, Lizzie and her sister, Emma Borden, lived with their father and step-mother but both rarely ate dinner with their father and step-mother. Lizzie's portrayal as a young helpless woman is far from her real life. She knew of her father's wealth, properties, and was confident enough to take a trip to Europe two years before her father was murdered. Even when the film attempts to be historical Brennan cannot do it properly.

Bridget Sullivan, the Bor-

See Monster on page 23



***Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story* trades truth for sensationalism.**





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Nancy is a California Department of Justice civil rights attorney, U.C. Berkeley Lecturer, and mom. As a 20-year Piedmont resident and volunteer, she understands the issues that matter most to our community.

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FEATURES

Walking on Wednesday

Wednesday walkers tour: Old and new architecture in the Piedmont City Center

Chapter 2

By Jim Kellogg

The Piedmont Recreation Department's Walking on Wednesdays group had an excellent turnout of 58 walkers and six K-9 best friends for its Oct. 14 walk, starting at the Exedra.

Jim Kellogg noted that this would be "Chapter 2" of his tour of Old and New Architecture in the Piedmont City Center, following his July 8 walk, moving from 1907 to the 1930s and on to mid-century modern. When it is done well, he said, old and new mix together into a seamless part of Piedmont's visual culture.

The group started up Guilford Avenue, past the site of the Piedmont Art Gallery, which Frank C. Havens hired Julia Morgan to design in 1907. It closed after only 11 years, and the public tennis courts stand there today.

The walk continued down Caperton Avenue, a beautiful, narrow street the group seldom walks, where Spanish Mission, Neo-Tudor, Piedmont Tradition and mid-century modern homes meld together.

On Highland, the group stopped at 55 Hazel Lane, a rare Piedmont example of Hollywood Regency style, built in 1937. Jim described its bold, sleek lines, flat roofs and metal railings, almost like a 20th-century cruise ship with added theater and glamour. Like most Regency homes, it has a dramatic formal entry and a luxurious pool. Gloria Swanson, Joan Crawford and Douglas Fairbanks were among the stars who embraced the style.

Next was 401 Wildwood Avenue, a 1964 mid-century modern masterwork and the only Piedmont house by Joe Esherick, who with William Wurster re-formed the UC Berkeley School of Architecture into the College of Environmental Design. Esherick is famous for The Sea Ranch, the Cannery at Fisherman's Wharf and the Monterey Bay Aquarium, and for simple, understated designs with no Hollywood glamour.

Next door, at 411 Wildwood, is a 1935 Monterey-style house. A revival of Spanish Mission with a romantic nod to the Old West, the style was made popular by stars such as Will Rogers, Clark Gable and Walt Disney. From 1991 to 2003 the house was home to KPIX journalist Wendy Tokuda, who, Mary Carter pointed out, was the daughter-in-law of Monty Hall of "Let's Make a Deal" fame.

Then came 431 Wildwood, a 6,500-square-foot "gothic revival" mansion designed by John Hudson Thomas and built in 1917, in the era when most of our city center went up. Jim pointed out that the three neighbors they had just seen span about 50 years of architecture, yet together they make Piedmont's architectural culture even richer.

The group continued along the narrow, beautifully landscaped road to 101 Wildwood Gardens, the Frank C. Havens Mansion. Bernard Maybeck's original 1907 design was an elegant two-story Arts and Crafts home stepping down into the canyon behind it. While it was under construction, Frank's wife, Lila, took charge. Enthralled with Asian design and with an unlimited budget, she partnered with Louis Comfort Tiffany on the central spaces, and the mansion came to hold the largest collection of Tiffany work west of the Mississippi. She also brought in artisans from Japan, China and Cambodia to hand-build a Japanese Tea Room, a Chinese Temple Room and Cambodian temple woodwork on the rear loggia. By its completion in 1914, the 11,000-square-foot mansion was known as "The Taj Mahal of Piedmont."

Maybeck and Lila parted ways before the work was finished. In fact, none of the Maybeck biographies include drawings or photos of the finished house.

For the handout, Meghan Bennett, who manages The History of Piedmont website, suggested using ChatGPT to turn old, scratchy black-and-white photos into clean color images, and she was right. They give a fresh look at the house as it was in 1914.



Jim Kellogg talking to the group on architecture walk

Jim then revealed a Hollywood connection. In the 1930s, a famous movie mogul, rumored to be Cecil B. DeMille, tried to buy the mansion, dismantle it and rebuild it in Hollywood. The Asian artisans' handwork proved too complex to move, and the offer was abandoned.

Across the street, at 21 Wildwood Gardens, is a 1952 mid-century modern house with flat roofs and extensive glass, from the era of Rudolph Schindler and Richard Neutra. Though more than 70 years old, Jim said, it more closely resembles 21st-century work than anything from 1914.

Farther down, at 89-95 Wildwood Gardens, is Maybeck's second Piedmont project, designed in 1907 as staff housing for the mansion. Its three units later became the first apartment building in Piedmont, and it was not modified by Lila Havens!

The tour ended at 120 Wildwood Gardens, Carr Jones's masterpiece Storybook house, built in 1932. This is his most famous "Hansel and Gretel" design, with hand-laid brick and hand-hewn beams throughout. To enhance the old look, the bricks were salvaged from a demolished St. Mary's College building on its Oakland campus, before the college moved to Moraga.

The group thanked Jim for an expansive, highly informative and wonderful tour and made its way back to the Exedra, looking forward to "Chapter 3."

Walking on Wednesdays meets weekly at 10:30 a.m. at the Exedra. The program is free and open to the public. Registration is at https://tinyurl.com/3ethkehu.



Among those participating were Al Chen, Alicia Rivera, Brenda Ferrero, Stacy Venetluhmamm, Lisa Euphrat, Mike Henn, Chuck Oraftik, Phil Witte, Nancy DeRoche with K-9 best friend Pepper, Judy Mateo, Mark Davis, Peggy Shultz, Marianne Jakus, Carol Quan, Jack Fischrup with K-9 best friend Kojak, Judy Love, Sherry Jacobs, Norman Quan, Dave DeRoche, Jim Kellogg, Noemi Alvarado, June Yee, Cathy Laymon, Kat Lang, Rich Harmes, Brian Hamlin, Liz Dalrymple, Nancy Henn with K-9 best friend Roger, Joan Jung with K-9 best friend JT, Alissa Quan, Debbie Powell, Denny McGee, Ken Moy, Stella Houston, Claudine Bach, Aileen DeSoto with K-9 best friend Hudson, Sunny Bostrom-Fleming, Judy Sokoloff, Irene Thompson, Susie Backer, Sean Brient with K-9 best friend Pip, Kristin Howard, Melba Yee, John Sumnicht, Adrienne Hamlin, Anne Gritzer, Mary Carter, Jim Kuo, Helen Dong, Quincy Dong, Lois Price, Albert Chen, Haideh Chew, and Dick Carter. The group was pleased to have Wendi Lelke-Wallway walking with them for the first time.

PUP TALKS

Fear not, Fido: Desensitizing your dog to everyday objects

By Sierra Berrick

One of the most common training conundrums is a dog who fears everyday objects. A sudden, forceful pull in the opposite direction because of a trash can can quickly take the joy out of a walk for any owner. Left unaddressed, these fears can persist or worsen, leading to an increasingly anxious dog and a frustrated owner. The good news is that, with patience, consistency, and plenty of positive reinforcement, you can help your dog become more confident. Let's explore how to desensitize your dog to common everyday scares.

Many of us have experienced the surprising, and sometimes painful, moment when our dog suddenly digs in their heels and refuses to pass an ordinary object. Common culprits include covered cars, as well as statues. Bring high-value treats and make sure your dog is securely fitted with a collar or harness to prevent them from running away. Before approaching the "scary" object, begin walking back and forth at a swift pace, changing direction suddenly and often to encourage your dog to focus on you rather than the object. Reward for walking calmly by your side. Use a high, happy voice and avoid comforting the dog, as this can make their fear worse. Gradually work toward passing the object, rewarding often. The goal is to help your dog build a positive association with the object, not simply to get past it.

Now let's discuss moving or noisy items, such as vacuums or rolling carts. Start by introducing the item while it is turned off or stationary. Keep your dog on a leash, allowing enough room for them to retreat six feet. Begin tossing treats on the floor, creating a trail that encourages your dog to approach the object voluntarily. Use a cheerful tone and reward each step toward the object. If your dog backs away, give them space but only reward for forward progress; never drag the dog toward the "scary" item. As your dog becomes comfortable, continue rewarding them for standing near or sniffing the object. Once they are relaxed around the stationary item, repeat this process with the object turned on and/or moving.

The key to overcoming everyday fears is patience, not pressure. Every dog progresses at a different pace, so celebrate small victories and keep training sessions short and positive. If your dog shows signs of intense fear or struggles to make progress, consider working with an experienced trainer. With time and trust, those once-terrifying trash cans, statues, and shiny floors can become just another part of the neighborhood.



A collie is rewarded for her proximity to a previously scary golf cart.

Sierra Berrick is a professional dog trainer and AKC Evaluator located in Oakland, California. She helped to launch the service dog and facility dog training organization Alpha Dog Assist in Mill Valley in 2021 and currently offers private training in service dog work, obedience, and behavioral consultation. To contact her, please call 510-507-2017, email Sierra109@gmail.com, or visit her website at www.oakhillsdogtraining.weebly.com.

Walking on Wednesdays special tour of Mt. View Cemetery on October 28

The Piedmont Recreation Department's Walking on Wednesdays group will return to the Mountain View Cemetery on October 28 for a special pre-Halloween tour conducted by docent Jane Leroe. Rather than meeting at the Exedra at Magnolia and Highland Avenues in Piedmont, as the group usually does on Wednesday mornings, walkers will meet in front of Mountain View's main mausoleum. The tour will start at 10:30 a.m. and last for about 1 hour and 30 minutes.

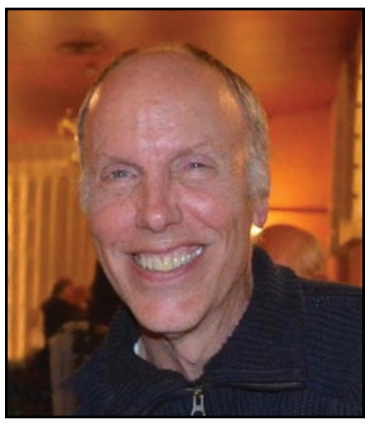
This will be the fifth year Leroe has given the tour for the Wednesday walkers. Last October she took the group on her Famous Families tour. This year the group will visit the Dunsmuirs, Kirkhams, Delgers, Heads, Pardees, and others.

It is a free event, and free parking is available on the streets inside the cemetery. Well-behaved dogs on leashes are allowed in the cemetery. For more information, contact activity leader Dick Carter at camktgrp@comcast.net.



Obituary

David Birnbaum dies on September 25



David Birnbaum

David Mark Birnbaum, retired Deputy General Counsel at the University of California, passed away on September 25, 2026, in Piedmont, CA, from metastatic prostate cancer. He was 75 years old and had lived in Piedmont for 32 years.

David was born in Passaic, New Jersey, to Jesse L. Birnbaum, long-time editor at Time magazine, and Elizabeth Haesly Birnbaum, a violist and music teacher. After growing up on Long Island, New York, David attended Colgate University for two years before moving to California to finish his undergraduate education at UC Santa Cruz, where he also learned to surf.

David completed his education at UC Berkeley School of Law, obtaining his J.D. in 1976. That fall, he moved to Washington, DC, where he found employment as a staff attorney with The Review Panel on New Drug Regulation, a part of the (then) Department of Health, Education and Welfare. There he investigated allegations made by doctors at the Food and Drug Administration that the pharmaceutical industry had undue influence on the new drug approval process. After wrapping up that investigation, David went to work at the US Justice Department in the Civil Rights Division, prosecuting housing, education, and voting rights cases.

In 1980, David returned to California, this time to Los Angeles where he worked for the law firm Gibson, Dunn and Crutcher for several years. In 1983, he moved back to the Bay Area to begin work in the Litigation Department of UC's Office of General Counsel. For the next 30 years, David served in a variety of roles in the Office of General Counsel: Campus Counsel for UC Santa Cruz, Campus Counsel for UC Santa Barbara, and eventually, Deputy General Counsel. Even after retirement, David returned to UC to provide counsel to UCLA, during a period when that office in Los Angeles was understaffed.

In 1984, David married Nancy Jean Marvel, a lawyer he met during his time in Washington, DC. After first settling in Oakland, they moved to Piedmont in 1994 where they raised their two daughters, Katie and Emily. David was an extremely active volunteer in his daughters' school; he would often be the only dad driving on field trips. He also helped out in the classroom by advising on and editing students' writing. He attended every sports game his daughters played, as well as every school play, and every concert during their lengthy tenure with the Piedmont Children's Choir. As a member of the Piedmont Community Church, David also taught Sunday School for many years when his daughters were young.

After their retirement in 2013, David and Nancy spent a year living abroad in Aix-en-Provence, France, and Seville, Spain. They took advantage of their time there to see much of both countries, as well as Portugal and Morocco. Upon their return to the United States, David became involved in many volunteer activities, including Writer Coach Connection in Oakland, Berkeley Men's Shelter, and Alameda County Food Bank. He joined the Board of Directors of Friends for Youth in Palo Alto, and served both as a deacon and as a member of the Board of Trustees for Piedmont Community Church.

During the last part of David's life, he and Nancy continued their travels around the world to China, India, Southeast Asia, Australia, New Zealand, Japan, the Amazon, Cuba, Tanzania, Peru, Brazil, Argentina, Mexico, and all over Europe. While traveling, David wrote extensively about these trips, publishing his observations and musings on Facebook. Once home, Nancy collected David's writings along with accompanying photos, in a series of books, which now number eighty-four.

David is survived by his wife Nancy, daughters Emily Birnbaum and Katie Stern, son-in-law Daniel Stern, grandsons Isaac and Elijah Stern, brother Nathan Birnbaum, and his beloved poodle Theo.

A memorial service celebrating David's life will be held at Piedmont Community Church, 400 Highland Avenue, on November 14, 2026, at 2:00 pm. In lieu of flowers, the family asks that tribute donations be made in David's memory to the East Bay SPCA.



Seniors

The curtain goes up as the Piedmont Seniors visit San Francisco's ACT

The Piedmont Seniors recently ventured to San Francisco to visit the American Conservatory Theater for its stage production of Alfred Hitchcock's North by Northwest. Before the show began, the seniors had lunch at an upstairs venue at the theater, along with other senior groups visiting from the East Bay.

After lunch, the group went to the theater for the show. Instead of recreating Hitchcock's classic suspense film, this ACT version of North by Northwest is a fast-paced parody that has wildly inventive stagecraft, including using four mobile revolving doors and suitcases that unfold into miniature pop-up models to recreate iconic settings like the Plaza Hotel, the United Nations, and Mount Rushmore. This production also features mid-century music, jazzy dance numbers, and a breaking of the fourth wall.

This production offers a dynamic seven-person cast and offers fast-paced physical comedy, dance, and acrobatics. Overall, it is a delightful, high-speed, and laugh-out-loud show that reimagines the 1959 Hitchcock classic with more of a childlike joy!

After the curtain closed, several cast members came back on stage to address the audience and answer questions.

All in all, as with all the Piedmont Seniors' excursions, it was a very interesting day had by all!

If you would like to find out more information about the Piedmont Seniors program, contact Janet Epstein, coordinator, at jepstein@piedmont.ca.gov. The Seniors meet monthly on Wednesday mornings from 10 a.m. to noon at the Piedmont Community Hall, 711 Highland Avenue, Piedmont, in addition to going on monthly excursions throughout the Bay Area.



The Piedmont Seniors enjoyed their first outing to visit San Francisco's ACT. Pictured are (L to R): Judy Wang, Nancy Everett, Susan McCreary, Elizabeth Wierzbianska, Sandra Ponce, Elene Manolis, Piedmont Seniors Coordinator Janet Epstein, James Ayotte, Fred Pemberton, Gloria Wilmer, and Rita Jones.



The Piedmont Seniors share a group lunch at ACT with members of the Pleasanton Senior Center.

The voice on the phone isn't always who you think

By Debbi DiMaggio

The phone rang one morning. My mom answered, and on the other end was her grandson, our son Chase. He was in trouble. He needed help, and he needed it now.

It wasn't Chase.

To this day, my mom is certain it was him. The voice was his. It sounded exactly like him. That is what stays with me.

Last year, Americans over 60 reported losing $7.7 billion to online criminals. That's a 59% jump in one year, across more than 201,000 victims, with an average loss of $38,500. More than 12,000 people lost over $100,000 each. Federal researchers estimate that fewer than one in twenty victims ever reports the crime, so the real number is far higher.

These are not careless people. They are our parents, our neighbors, our friends. More and more, they are us.

So what changed? Artificial intelligence.

The old "grandparent scam" relied on a muffled voice and a bad connection. Today a scammer needs only a few seconds of audio, pulled from a Facebook video or even a voicemail greeting, to clone the voice of someone you love. The call comes at 11 p.m. There's been an accident. Don't tell Mom and Dad. Please hurry.

The FBI logged thousands of AI-related fraud complaints last year, with losses in the hundreds of millions. The technology is cheap, easy to find, and getting better every month.

The four scams costing seniors the most

- **Investment fraud.** This is now nearly half of all senior losses. It often starts with a friendly text "sent to the wrong number." Over weeks or months, a friendship grows. Then comes an introduction to a trading platform showing incredible returns. The account balance is a screenshot. The money is gone.
- **Tech support scams.** More than $1 billion lost last year. A pop-up or phone call claims to be Apple, Microsoft, or your bank and asks for remote access to your computer.
- **Romance scams.** Built slowly and patiently on Facebook, Instagram, or dating apps. Then, suddenly, there's an emergency.
- **Recovery scams.** This one breaks my heart. Shortly after someone has been scammed, a "helper" reaches out promising to recover the money, and then takes whatever is left.

A word from my world

If you are buying or selling a home, wire fraud is very real. Criminals watch transaction emails and send fake wiring instructions days before closing. Never wire money based on an email. Pick up the phone, call your escrow officer at a number you already have, and confirm out loud. We tell every one of our clients this, and I will keep saying it.

Six habits that protect us

1. **Pause for ten minutes.** Urgency is their weapon. Anything real can wait ten minutes. A scam can't.
2. **Hang up and call back** on a number you already have, never the one they give you.
3. **Choose a family code word.** Something only your family knows. Ask for it before you send anything.
4. **Never give anyone remote access to your computer**, and never send cryptocurrency to someone you met online. No legitimate bank or agency will ask you to put cash into a crypto kiosk.
5. **Talk to someone before you act.** Scammers count on you feeling alone. Seniors who call a family member first are far less likely to lose money.
6. **Always report it.** File at ic3.gov or call the Justice Department's Elder Fraud Hotline at 1-833-FRAUD-11. Being targeted by a professional criminal is nothing to be ashamed of.

Please forward this to your parents, your children, your friends and your neighbors. Then pick up the phone and talk it through. That one conversation could protect someone you love.

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The MacMama

Computer tips and helpful suggestions, especially for people who are not entirely comfortable using their computers.

Dear MacMama,

We are in our 80s. I have been a Mac user for decades and am comfortable (at this point) in the world of technology. But my wife is not at all, and I am starting to see some symptoms of dementia. She really wants a new iPhone, and I would love to get her one. All she really needs is the phone, messages and the camera. She does not need to get email on her phone. Is there a way to make it much simpler for her?

P.L., Oakland

Dear P.L.,

That's a great question, and yes, Apple has some features that most people don't know about to make the iPhone experience simpler for those who need an easier interface.

Apple has a somewhat new feature (since September 2023 with iOS 17) called *Assistive Access*. This is a way to simplify the phone with a distraction-free interface. It can be set up with only the apps she will use, with large icons and text, and limited features.

To set this up, make sure the phone is updated to the latest operating system. If you're planning to get a new iPhone, if it's not already at the latest, it will request that you update it when you start the phone setup. Once the phone is activated with your carrier and you have signed your wife into her Apple ID (or you make her a new one), you are ready to customize the phone into a much easier interface for her.

Here are step-by-step directions. Go to *Settings* and choose *Accessibility*. Scroll all the way down until you see *Assistive Access* under *General* (in *Accessibility*). Choose that and then select *Set Up Assistive Access*, then *Continue*. Then you will confirm the Apple account of the primary user and press *Continue*. Then it will give you a list of apps that have been optimized for this feature with options that you can customize. The list of optimized apps is not long (you can still add other apps that have not been adapted for *Assistive Access*) and as you choose them, you will be given options. For example, when you choose *Calls*, you can choose whether the user can make and receive calls from contacts, favorites, or anyone. And you can decide whether voicemail is visible and choose to have both the keypad and the speaker available. Since your wife likes the camera, you can choose whether she can take photos only, or videos and photo and video selfies. With *Messages* you have similar options to the phone app, with an added feature of having messages read aloud by tapping. The other apps that have been adapted are *Magnifier*, *Music*, *Photos* and *TV*. When you have chosen all the apps that you want on the phone, scroll all the way to the bottom and select *Continue*. Then you will choose how you would like the icons to appear, either in rows or a grid. I find the grid to be easier for most people. After you choose this, you will be presented with a screen that informs you that to use emergency services or to exit *Assistive Access* you must triple-click the side button. If you have set up Face ID and a passcode, it will confirm that this has been set, but you will be guided to set up an *Assistive Access* passcode, which will allow you to turn this feature off. At this point, you can also set up a recovery Apple account, which I assume would be yours, in case she forgets her passcode. And then you will get instructions to exit *Assistive Access*. Finally, you will select the *Start Using Assistive Access* button.

Of course, you can choose to keep the default iPhone interface, and just remove apps that she's not using, but you can't really remove the features that might be confusing, for example, on the camera. You can also, of course, make the text bigger and bold, increase the contrast, and make sure her most-used apps, like the phone, messages, and the camera, are in the dock. But with *Assistive Access*, your wife can have access to all of her photos, be able to call all of her friends and loved ones, and still take advantage of the excellent cameras on the newer iPhones.

Cookie Segelstein is the MacMama, an Apple Certified Service Professional who provides Apple computer consultation and troubleshooting in your home and office. For more information, call 510-520-7760, email cookie@themacmama.com, or visit her website at www.themacmama.com

Mayor Andersen

Continued from page 1

extraordinary privilege, and it has also been an eye-opening learning experience," said Andersen.

Andersen's first lesson was that Piedmont's finances are more constrained than residents might expect. Because Piedmont is "built out" and almost entirely residential, she said, it lacks the commercial revenue neighboring cities rely on. The city brings in less revenue per resident than Oakland, Berkeley, and Emeryville. Meanwhile, construction costs have risen 66% since she joined the council.

"It's important to start with being honest about the constraints we're facing because they shape every decision we make together as a city. But like a good story arc, I promise it gets better from here. Despite every one of those constraints, we have accomplished remarkable things, and it's because of our people," said Andersen.

Despite the city's financial limitations, Andersen's message is that the community must plan for the future and find ways to improve. As an example, she said that during her first term the council identified three looming problems: unfunded pension obligations, rising retiree health costs, and a growing backlog of deferred maintenance. She said the city's careful planning and fiscal responsibility, including during the COVID-19 pandemic, addressed those problems before they became crises and freed the city to focus on capital projects like the Community Pool and the new dispatch center.

"Every one of these proactive efforts that I've just highlighted began the same way, with people in our community who looked at Piedmont and believed we could do better, and then stepped up to do something about it," said Andersen.

Her final lesson learned was that when the community is united, it can achieve remarkable things. Andersen highlighted the improved Sidekicks programming, the community effort to build the sustainable parks management plan, and the community pool's fundraising as ways the residents came together to improve the city.

"Every generation of Piedmonters has inherited a city that someone before them chose to build. Now we are building for the ones who come next," she said.

During Andersen's tenure as Mayor, her council oversaw several significant projects. Some of these include the Piedmont Community Pool, a new 9-1-1 Dispatch Center, a new ambulance for the fire department, Objective Design Standards for new housing, improvements to parks and tot lots, and upgrades to roads and sewer systems. The city's future projects include completing the Moraga Avenue safety project, the Piedmont Park Tot Lot, updating the Safer Streets Plan, and the Dearing Memorial project.

Mayor Andersen concluded her speech by expressing her gratitude to the community and bidding an emotional farewell.

"I'm leaving office with more confidence than ever in Piedmont's future, because I know it is in good hands. Now put those hands together, Piedmont. Serving with you has been the honor of my lifetime," said Andersen.

The event was recorded and is expected to be released on the City of Piedmont's social media in the coming weeks.



Mayor Andersen with her family after her State of the City address.

Monster

Continued from page 19

den's live-in maid, did not have a secret relationship with Borden. Emma Borden, Lizzie's sister, was not going around seducing men for gifts and money only to break off her relationship with them. Possibly the worst fabrication was about Aileen Wuornos being comically infatuated with Borden, it is impossible for her to have stayed at the Borden Bed and Breakfast Museum. Nobody should think that Wuornos had a tenth of the kind of life that Lizzie Borden had.

Aileen was raised in poverty, was sexually abused and beaten by multiple family members, and had no chance for a life like Lizzie. Abby Borden, Lizzie's stepmother, was a church-going woman, who constantly helped with charity. Abby was not a person that mentally tortured Lizzie as the series insinuates.

While every moment is a twist or jumble of the truth, the actors do an amazing job at portraying the types of characters Ian Brennan wants them to be.

This show stars Ella Beatty as Lizzie Borden, Charlie Hunnam as Andrew Borden, Rebecca Hall as Abby Borden, Vicky Krieps as Bridget Sullivan, and Sarah Paulson as Aileen Wuornos.

Paulson was a terrific choice to be Wuornos, she nailed the historical aesthetic and accent of Wuornos.

This show does not stay historical to the events, except for basic facts. Ian Brennan uses a real double homicide for theatrical telling about people that did not do the things he says. *Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story* harms all reality around the people mentioned in the show.

***Monster: The Lizzie Borden Story** on Netflix marks the 4th season of Netflix's overall Monster true-crime anthology. The series consists of eight episodes, each episode runs from 45-60 minutes. Rated TV-MA.*

Girls' Tennis

Continued from page 10

No. 2 doubles, where Ella Thomasson and Mai Pham won a 6-0, 6-0 sweep. Amalia Angulo and Penelope Welch closed the day with a 6-4, 6-4 win at No. 3 doubles.

4-3 to Alameda

At singles, Ruthven had a clean 6-0, 6-0 sweep at the No. 1 spot. Also winning was Huynh at No. 3 in a one-sided 6-1, 6-1 victory. Sivakumar put together a 6-3, 6-2 win at No. 4.

Chin had a narrow match at the No. 2 singles spot and held match point in the third-set tiebreaker, but fell 2-6, 6-3, 10-8.

Alameda won all three doubles matches to propel them to the victory. Chan and Silvio lost 7-6 (8-6), 6-3 at No. 1. Thomasson and Pham had a three set loss at the No. 2 spot, 5-7, 6-2, 10-6. Layla Reed-Miguel and Amelia Oldrin lost 6-3, 6-3 at No. 3.

Tuesday vs. Bishop O'Dowd

Piedmont hosted Bishop O'Dowd for a league match on Tuesday, October 20. See next week's *Post* for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (11-5 overall, 4-1 league) hosts Castro Valley tomorrow, October 22, at 3:30 p.m.

Flag Football

Continued from page 12

broke the deadlock in the second quarter with 9:32 remaining, giving them a 6-0 lead after a failed one-point conversion.

Both teams traded possession another four times – which featured an interception by Nea Mafi – before PHS got on the board. The Highlanders scored with 1:17 left in the first half after starting a drive from the Dragons' 27 after a long punt return by Prata Baack. Piedmont scored in three plays, which featured a 14-yard carry by Mafi before she scored on a 10-yard where she evaded two defenders on her way to the end zone. A missed conversion tied it 6-6.

O'Dowd scored on the final possession of the half as time expired, scoring on a near 20-yard pass. They led 12-6 after a failed conversion.

But from there, the Dragons took over. They scored at the 6:22 mark of the third quarter to go up 18-6. PHS then drove to the BOD 31, but their series stalled out. O'Dowd came back with a nine-play touchdown series with 9:44 left in the fourth quarter, making it 25-6 after a successful conversion. They scored again with 8:15 left, 31-6.

Piedmont had a long 12-play series down to the O'Dowd 12, but an interception ended the drive on 4th-and-goal.

Tuesday vs. Mt. Eden

Piedmont hosted Mt. Eden for the first round of the WACC Tournament on Tuesday, October 20.

NEXT UP

Should Piedmont win on Tuesday, Piedmont will in the WACC semifinals on Thursday, October 22.

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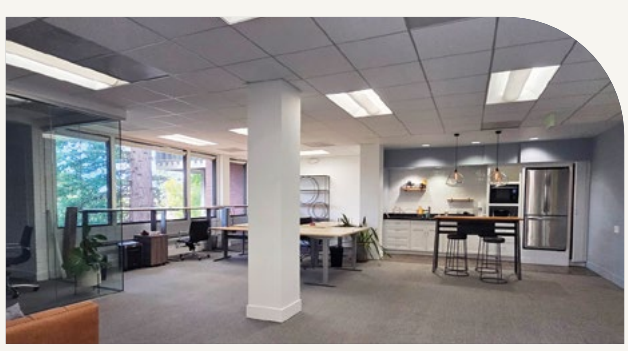
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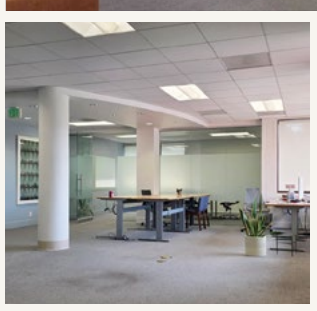
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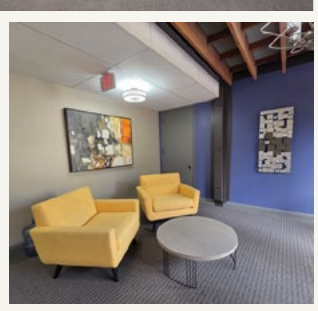
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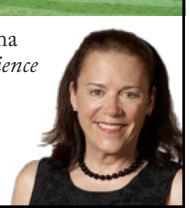
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Letters to the Editor

Continued from page 3

transfer tax will affect transaction costs for both parties. This is not a cost to dismiss lightly. However, I believe we must also consider the long-term financial health of the community we call home.

The June 2026 report from Piedmont's Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee warns that the City's Facilities Capital Fund is projected to be essentially depleted after fiscal year 2027–28, while aging buildings, roads, sidewalks, and storm drains require significant investment.

Measure GG offers a responsible way to help address these needs and preserve the public services and infrastructure that make Piedmont such a desirable place to live. Deferring necessary maintenance risks making repairs more expensive in the future.

As residents, we have a responsibility to plan ahead and preserve our community's quality for future generations. I believe the long-term benefits of Measure GG outweigh the additional real estate transaction costs.

I urge Piedmont voters to vote YES on Measure GG. I have financially contributed to the campaign to pass Measure GG.

Sincerely,
–Pamela Fullerton, Realtor

Bill Reichle for City Council

Editor:

I want to take this opportunity to say a few words about Bill Reichle and why he will receive my vote on November 3 for city council. I have had the good fortune of knowing Bill as a neighbor and friend for over twenty-five years. He ranks at the top of the list in both categories. Friendship aside, Bill has always stayed well informed on the issues facing Piedmont. I agree with his support of Measure GG and his vision for the use of those funds. He has my vote as I believe he will be an excellent City Council member.

–Jim Sells

Support Tom Ramsey for City Council

Editor:

I'm writing today to express my support for Tom Ramsey's reelection campaign for City Council. As someone who has spent most of my life as a part of the Piedmont community and had the chance to work directly with Tom during his first term on Council, I continue to see the positive impact he's had on Piedmont. Tom's experience as an architect will continue to positively impact discussions about development in Moraga Canyon and around town. His experience in the community and as an executive will continue to inform and impact discussions about the many issues which will come before the Council in the next four years.

Tom works to make sure all viewpoints are heard and considered by the Council. He's focused on solutions which will help our community move forward. His time on the Council has shown his problem solving, collaborative approach yields results that fit Piedmont.

Please join me in supporting Tom Ramsey reelection to the City Council in November's election.

Thanks,
–John O. Tulloch

Adam Hundt for City Council

Dear Piedmont Residents:

I am writing to endorse Adam Hundt for Piedmont City Council in this election. I grew up in Piedmont in the 1990s and watched my father, a civil engineer and lawyer, participate in City Council meetings given his expertise. He wanted to help the community succeed and appreciated in this small-town environment there was an opportunity for him to engage directly with city government.

I see in Adam qualities I respected in my father. Like my dad, Adam is eager to utilize his knowledge and expertise to address issues facing our city government. Given Piedmont's numerous government functions — from city works to housing to parks and recreation — there is a need for someone with Adam's curiosity and tenacity.

Adam understands how to create public policies that are understandable, fair, and crafted to achieve specific strategic outcomes. He is honest, down to earth, and humble. When examining issues, he seeks out different opinions and perspectives.

He may be new to Piedmont city government, but the city would benefit from having his perspective and problem-solving abilities on Council. I am excitedly supporting Adam for City Council and encourage other residents to do the same.

Sincerely,
–Katie Hendrickson

Proud to support Nancy Beninati

Dear Editor:

As a Piedmont resident since 1987 and active member of the community, I am proud to support Nancy Beninati for City Council. Nancy and I worked closely in the League of Women Voters of Piedmont when she was President, and I have seen firsthand her dedication, thoughtful leadership, and commitment to public service.

I also witnessed Nancy present her work on the Racial and Identity Profiling Act (RIPA) to then-Attorney General Xavier Becerra at a RIPA Board meeting. I was impressed by her knowledge and her commitment to advancing equality and justice. Her work reflects not only her professional experience but also her commitment to fairness, accountability, and making our government work for everyone.

She brings that same commitment to her service in Piedmont. Nancy understands our community, listens to others, and approaches challenging issues with care and integrity. Her years of public service, combined with her knowledge of the issues in Piedmont, make her exceptionally well qualified to serve on our City Council.

Please join me in voting for Nancy. Piedmont would be fortunate to have her experience, values, and dedication working on behalf of everyone.

–Lois Corrin
Piedmont Resident for 39 Years
Founder of Piedmont's Annual Celebration of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

Endorsing Bill Reichle

To the Editor:

We are proud to endorse Bill Reichle for Piedmont City Council. Over nearly 30 years, we have developed enormous respect for his integrity, work ethic, and his ability to get things done for the communities he serves. Bill takes public service seriously but with humility. He does his homework, listens carefully, treats people with respect even when they disagree, stays after the meeting to reflect and forge consensus, and then delivers on his word. Those qualities are rarer than they should be in public life, but they are the hallmarks of our best public servants.

Bill's leadership at UC Berkeley prepared him ideally for the Piedmont City Council. He knows how to build a budget and to prioritize the things that have made Piedmont such a good place to live: strong schools, safe streets, community engagement, and good neighbors. Most of all, we trust Bill's judgment, and know his character. If elected, he will work hard for every resident of Piedmont. We hope you'll join us in voting to elect Bill.

–Jeff and Becky Bleich

Vote for Nancy Beninati

Dear Editor:

Having collaborated with Nancy Beninati for the League of Women Voters of Piedmont and knowing of her important work with the California Department of Justice and Goldman School of Public Policy at U.C. Berkeley along with her volunteerism in the schools and sports, I have always thought that she would be a dream candidate for Piedmont City Council. Well, dreams can come true and I was thrilled when she announced her candidacy.

Her greatest assets, I believe, will be her integrity and determination to listen to her neighbors' thoughts and opinions and carefully consider their needs. When addressing opposing views, Nancy has demonstrated the rare ability to look deeply into underlying community pressures as well as common goals to find a fair position. Nancy always does the investigative work and is never swayed by strong forces. I trust Nancy to meet our needs on even the most difficult issues.

Please join me in voting on November 3, and I urge you to cast your vote for Nancy Beninati.

–Christy VanSlyke
Piedmont Public Safety Committee

Vote for Adam Hundt

Editor:

I recently had an opportunity to sit down with Adam Hundt because he wanted to hear from a longtime resident about changes in our city. As a resident of more than 60 years, I was able to share my memories of a time when Piedmont's city center had more retail establishments, traffic was safer, and the air was cleaner. I was impressed by Adam's willingness to listen, ask thoughtful questions, and explore how our city has changed.

With his background in business development, Adam could help bring new retail opportunities to our city center, generating additional revenue and fostering a greater sense of community. His extensive experience in public policy could also help Piedmont develop clean energy technologies that lower utility bills while preserving our clean air.

Adam is a young father with many responsibilities, yet he is willing to devote his time, energy and skills to maintaining and improving our lovely city.

Please vote for Adam Hundt on Tuesday, Nov. 3.

Sincerely,
–Elene Manolis
Retired Havens teacher

Nancy Beninati for City Council

Editor,

I am writing to endorse Nancy Beninati for Piedmont City Council.

I have lived in Piedmont for almost 50 years and have known many members of City Council. I have also served on numerous local boards (School Board, Ed Foundation, Boy Scouts, League of Women Voters), co-chaired Bond Campaigns and volunteered in various ways over the decades. As a result of these experiences, I believe I have insight into what it takes to serve effectively on the Piedmont City Council.

With that in mind, I can state categorically that I believe Nancy has the qualities and experience needed to be a highly successful City Council member. She is a long-term resident of Piedmont; has served on the Recreation and Civil Service Commissions and been President of the League of Women Voters; has decades of experience in the CA Department of Justice as a Supervising Deputy Attorney General in civil rights; and is a lecturer in public policy at UC Berkeley. She also has twin boys at PHS.

If you, like me, seek City Council members who are competent, collegial and committed to their community and its values, I encourage you to vote for Nancy Beninati.

–Ward Lindenmayer

Adam Hundt has our vote

Dear Editor of the Post:

My name is Don Tamaki, and together with my wife, Suzie Ah-Tye, we have resided in Piedmont since 1993 and raised our twin sons in this community. It is with great pleasure to support Adam Hundt for City Council. We have enjoyed getting to know Adam as our neighbor, and found him to be informed, knowledgeable, curious, open-minded, approachable, and genuinely motivated to work diligently in the best interest of the community.

The Council and Piedmont residents would benefit from Adam's expertise in energy, climate policy, and wildfire mitigation. He has fresh ideas and perspectives to offer in these areas. We also had the opportunity to discuss with him matters of diversity and equity, and appreciated his responses. Finally, we note that he is the only candidate endorsed by the Alameda County Democratic Party.

Adam Hundt has our vote.

–Don Tamaki and Suzie Ah-Tye

Vote for Bill Reichle for City Council

To the Editor:

We've known Bill Reichle for years, and know him as a kind, thoughtful person who listens well and genuinely cares about others. As a parent, he understands what makes Piedmont such a special place to raise a family.

In preparing for his run for Piedmont City Council, Bill has done his homework: meeting with city leaders and staff, studying the budget, and learning firsthand about the challenges facing the city. His priorities are straightforward: public safety, fiscal responsibility, and community engagement. As Bill puts it, without public safety, nothing else matters. Without fiscal discipline, nothing else is possible.

Bill brings both a good heart and a willingness to do the hard work. We're proud to call him our friend, and we're voting for him for City Council. We hope you will too.

–Pete & Amanda

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Ballot Ratings

Continued from page 3

age of increase if the proposed measure were to pass. Common among general tax increases was a listing of popular or feel-good spending categories like emergency services, parks, pothole repairs, or homeless services that would be improved if the measure were to pass. But as a general tax, the proceeds could be spent on any public purpose, and nothing might be spent on the listed areas. But as stated above, all the measures exhibited some degree of proponent bias, emphasizing the benefits and glossing over the costs, meaning the authors want the measure to pass.

MEASURE RTM

Public Transit Revenue Measure District Proposition RTM

To prevent major service cuts to BART and other transit, avoid increased traffic, and reduce pollution by: Preserving BART, Caltrain, VTA, SamTrans, AC Transit, Muni, other transit for everyone, including workers, students, seniors, persons with disabilities; Supporting transit safety, cleanliness, affordability, reliability; Repairing targeted roads/potholes; Requiring financial transparency, oversight, accountability; shall the measure enacting a 0.5% (Alameda, Contra Costa, San Mateo, Santa Clara counties), and 1% (San Francisco) sales tax for 14 years generating approximately $980,000,000 annually, be adopted?

Vote Required: 50%+1

Criteria:

1. Intent and structure of the tax (i.e. a % or rate for a sales or transfer tax, or a $ per parcel or square foot for a parcel tax).
2. Amount of tax generated per year and the duration of the tax.
3. Is this a Special or General tax? (The more specifically it's described, the more easily one can figure out which it is, and the more credit they get.)
4. Where is the money specifically going? (particularly if a special tax).
5. Is there an existing or similar tax already in place? If so, that tax information should be included.

SCORE: 3.2

Comments: The score was lowered from the maximum of five because of the failure to provide meaningful information on where the money was specifically going. As described, the money was going everywhere without apparent priority. There was also no mention of whether there were any existing taxes in place, ignoring the sizable existing Alameda County one-cent sales tax already being collected for transportation. There is also a lack of needed clarity as to how the multi-county voting will work.

MEASURE GG

Real Property Conveyance Tax Measure

Shall the measure, providing funding for City of Piedmont's essential city services, such as police, fire, and emergency medical response; and maintenance of aging City buildings, parks, stormwater drains, roads and sidewalks, by increasing the real estate transfer tax from 1.3% to 1.75% to be more in line with neighboring cities and to generate approximately $1,500,000 annually in general tax revenue until ended by voters, be adopted?

Vote Required: 50%+1

Criteria:

1. Intent and structure of the tax (i.e., a % or rate for a sales or transfer tax, or a $ per parcel or square foot for a parcel tax).
2. Amount of tax generated per year and the duration of the tax.
3. Is this a Special or General tax? (The more specifically it's described, the more easily one can figure out which it is, and the more credit they get.)
4. Where is the money specifically going? (particularly if a special tax).
5. Is there an existing or similar tax already in place? If so, that tax information should be included.

SCORE: 4.5

Comments: The score was lowered from the maximum of five because it is misleading to say that the proceeds may go to the popular listed topics of parks, storm drains, police, fire, etc. This is a general tax, the proceeds of which can go to any city expense, and none may go to the listed recipients of the proceeds. The claim that the tax would remain until "ended by voters" is deceptive because it implies there is a mechanism within the measure allowing for a public opportunity to terminate the tax. Instead, there is no probable way to end this tax other than the difficult citizen initiative process. Effectively, this tax would probably be permanent.



Candidates' Q&A

Continued from page 1

Square, take the ferry across the Bay, and pedal to the office. It's fun, and believe me, I don't often say that about commuting. So, I understand the growing popularity of e-bikes.

When Chief Shavies presented the topic to the City Council, he highlighted a critical issue I hadn't thought about: many parents buy e-bikes for their kids without realizing that certain models, or modified ones, can reach high speeds and operate more like e-motorcycles.

I strongly agree with Chief Shavies that this isn't an anti-e-bike conversation; it's all about safety. Our top priority must be education and community outreach to encourage responsible riding, not issuing tickets to kids. We should partner closely with our schools to spread safety awareness and explore practical local guidelines for street and sidewalk use that complement state legislation.

I was glad to see that the Chief didn't waste any time getting on Instagram and Facebook to get the word out to local families as we begin our education and outreach campaign.

Bill Reichle
(http://reichleforpiedmont.com/)

eBikes make up two-thirds of all bicycle sales in the United States, and their popularity is growing. My friends, who are advocates, claim that electric assist has allowed them to enjoy biking at an age when others typically stop.

California law classifies eBikes by speed and motor yet designates them as bicycles, not motor vehicles. I believe the current regulatory framework for eBikes is sufficient for operator safety, but only if the laws are understood and followed. For that reason, I see this as a communication challenge as opposed to a legislative issue.

I support Chief Shavies' efforts in educating Piedmont parents about the age-appropriate class of e-bike for their family as well as the potential for more severe injury from the additional power e-bike feature.

When I worked at UC Berkeley, the most serious injuries involving e-bike on campus were not to operators but to pedestrians with whom the e-bike came into contact. If you have never had an e-bike silently whiz by you at 25 miles per hour, it can be unsettling. I would welcome study and discussion with Piedmont Police if there are locations in town where e-bike restrictions would minimize the potential for pedestrian injury.

Nancy Beninati
(http://nancyforpiedmont.com/)

I have never ridden an e-bike, but I help coach the Piedmont High Mountain Bike Team. I believe e-bikes can help more people enjoy cycling and provide an environmentally friendly alternative to driving, particularly in hilly Piedmont.

The Chief's concerns about safety and education are important. Parents and young riders need to understand the differences between pedal-assist e-bikes and throttle-powered bikes.

Currently, California has no statewide minimum age for throttle-powered bikes, which allow riders to accelerate up to 20 mph without pedaling. Recognizing rising injuries, the Legislature authorized a pilot program in Marin County permitting local jurisdictions to prohibit riders under 16 from using these throttle-powered bikes and requiring helmets for all riders. In support, e-bike advocates argued that throttle-powered bikes pose greater safety risks because they can accelerate from zero to 20 mph in 10 seconds with a simple push of the throttle. In contrast, pedal-assist e-bikes require riders to pedal to engage the motor, limiting how quickly they accelerate.

Given these safety concerns, Piedmont should explore a similar measure while evaluating the legal authority, safety benefits, and practical implications. We should also prioritize education, parental awareness, and enforcement of existing laws, while also drawing on other jurisdictions' experiences.

Nancy (Sunny) Bostrom

I have a lifelong interest in bicycling for two reasons: the Ironman triathlon is my sport of choice. I train nearly every day by running, swimming, and biking. My everyday zero-gear bike is my main source of transportation. The second reason is that my grandfather gave my grandmother a bicycle in addition to an engagement ring when he proposed in 1898.

In 2013, there were about 650 e-bike injuries; by 2023, that number had increased to about 34,000 injuries. The most serious of these injuries are TBI's Traumatic Brain Injuries, which increased from 163 in 2017 to 7,922 in 2022 an increase of 49 times. In addition to the pain and misery, there is a financial impact on families. The cost of care for the first year after a TBI injury is approximately 1.5 million dollars. An injured ten-year-old can require 70 more years of care. (https://whatebikeshouldibuy.com/ebike-injury-statistics/)

California Highway Patrol has online classes. It's important to have our children educated in the primary grades about the safety concerns of e-bikes. Our students should be taught how to safely operate their bikes and e-bikes in a world of two-ton cars and trucks. Helmets are vital for riders and their passengers.

Candidate Scorecard Week 8

Candidates	Top 3 issues facing Piedmont	Top 3 infrastructure needs in Piedmont	Moraga Canyon Specific Plan	Do you support the Fire Dept. union	Flock Safety concerns	E-Bike Safety
Adam Hundt	Affordable electrification and energy-efficient home upgrades, building new homes, and raising city revenue	Mitigating risk from hazards that could affect residents' housing, and maintaining roads and bike pathways	Ensure noise levels are controlled in compliance with wildfire safety protocols, and preserve Coaches Field and the Corporation Yard.	The City Council should present a plan for the police and fire departments. Maintain services in a way that is fair to the union members and ensures that the departments are adequately funded.	Before voting to renew the contract, Hundt would investigate if and how data gathered from Piedmont's Flock cameras is used. He supports public safety measures, but acknowledges residents' legitimate privacy concerns.	Will work with Piedmont Police on messaging around e-bikes. Could explore a similar ordinance passed in Danville, which required e-bike riders to walk devices in park spaces and limits speeds on trails.
Tom Ramsey (*Incumbent*)	Community safety, fiscal responsibility, and maintaining the beauty of our town	Sewers and storm drains, pavement management, and aging civic buildings	Needs to see a commitment to the vision the community developed through numerous public workshops.	Committed to continuing transparent, good-faith dialogue to reach a sustainable agreement.	Supports the use of cameras and ALPR technology. Current system does not use facial recognition. Data is encrypted and automatically deleted on a 30-day rolling timeline, and is owned 100% by the city.	Our top priority must be education and community outreach to encourage responsible riding, not issuing tickets to kids.
Bill Reichle	Moraga Canyon housing, sustainability, and updating century-old city facilities	Street paving, ADA upgrades, and updating older city buildings.	Focused on public safety, traffic circulation, pedestrian and bicycle safety, and wildfire mitigation.	Would use Measure GG revenue to help fund the fire department and help Piedmont compete in a competitive employment market.	Believes in the usefulness of ALPR's cameras. Believes any decision to issue or renew a contract for ALPRs would require listening to Piedmont residents.	Would welcome study and discussion with Piedmont Police if there are locations in town where eBike restrictions would minimize the potential for pedestrian injury.
Nancy Beninati	Public Safety, Good Governance, Preserving Community and Sustainability	Maintaining streets and sidewalks, upgrading stormwater systems, and modernizing public facilities	Delivers the required affordable housing, is financially and legally sound, and enhances the community.	Supports fair compensation while also making sure that any agreement is financially sustainable and treats all employees fairly.	ALPRs can be a valuable tool for law enforcement, but require appropriate oversight, accountability, and transparency.	Explore a similar measure as Marin County, which permitted local jurisdictions to prohibit riders under 16 from using these throttle-powered bikes and requiring helmets for all riders.
Nancy (Sunny) Bostrom	*No response received*	Street and sidewalk paving, plus improvements to police, fire, and school infrastructure.	We need community input to ensure we keep our citizens, children, pets, and wildlife safe.	Would use revenue from Measure GG to help to fund increased benefits for the department.	Supports the use of ALPR cameras and believes in their effectiveness in reducing crime. Believes we need to review the agencies receiving this information.	The rise in injuries is a serious concern. Recommends increased messaging for online classes to help teach younger kids how to safely operate their bikes and e-bikes.

*All candidates support Measure GG

Boys' Water Polo

Continued from page 10

Piedmont added two more goals by Patty within the first two minutes of the third quarter to lead 10-4 with 5:27 left. Lick-Wilmerding then scored three straight to cut the deficit to 10-7 with 2:21 remaining in the quarter. Smith got PHS' 11th with 23 seconds left.

In the fourth, Piedmont continued its scoring with three straight goals by Patty, Stein, and Raffi Banin with 5:15 on the clock. Lick got its final goal with 3:41 remaining, leading to a defensive exchange for the remaining time. Stein got the Highlanders' final goal with 43 seconds left, 15-8.



Rylan Patty scored five goals against Lick-Wilmerding.

Final scorers: Stein scored seven goals, Patty had five goals, Smith had two, and Banin scored once.

Tuesday vs. Bishop O'Dowd

Piedmont hosted Bishop O'Dowd on Tuesday, October 20 for its regular season finale. See next week's *Post* for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (10-10 overall, 3-2 league) competes in the 2026 WACC Tournament on Tuesday, October 27 at Encinal.

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2026 Calendar of Events

October 21 - October 28

Wednesday, October 21

7:30 p.m. ..... Recreation Commission Meeting ..... City Hall

Saturday, October 24

11:00 a.m. ..... 39th Annual Halloween Celebration ..... 3868 Piedmont Ave
1:00 p.m. ..... PRD Floating Pumpkin Patch ..... Piedmont Community Pool

Wednesday, October 28

7:00 p.m. ..... Board of Education Meeting ..... City Hall

Meetings may be viewed on KCOM (Channel 27) and on the City's website: piedmont.ca.gov.

Pumpkin Patch

Continued from page 1

but he was worth it," said Patch Papa Matt Derrigo.

"My favorite part is seeing new parents bring their babies to meet Jack for their very first Halloween pictures."

Stop by the patch and make your guess in before it's too late: The last day to guess is Tuesday, October 27. The person with the closest guess of Giant Jack's weight wins Giant Jack or a pumpkin assortment delivered to your home before Halloween

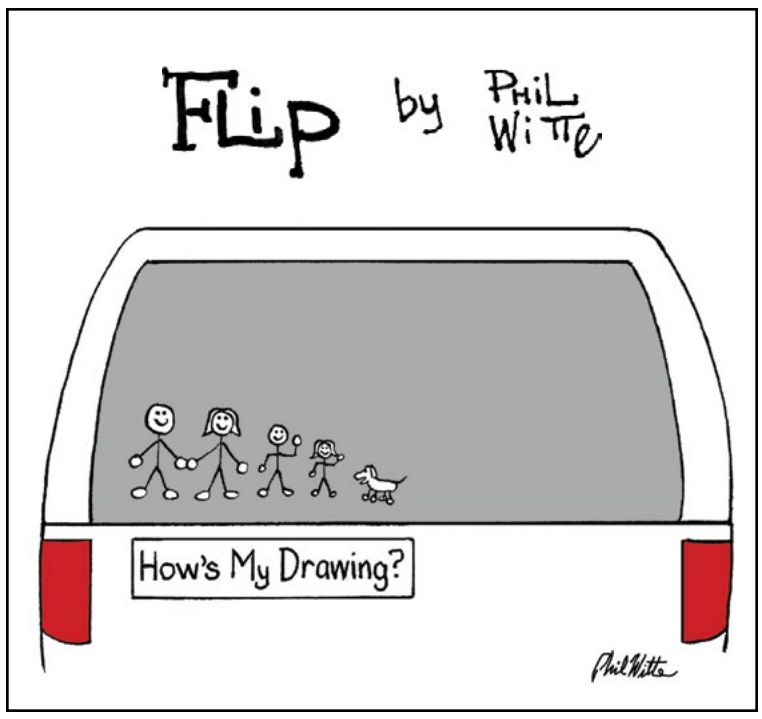
The WWDC would like to issue a special shout-out to a former Wildwood family for getting the pumpkins moving this year at top speed.

"The Fuji-Higashis donated a classic Radio Flyer wagon to the patch. It's a much-welcomed addition, and we're grateful for their generosity" said Patch Papa Brian Fischer.

With All Hollows' Eve 10 days away, the Wildwood Dads Club Pumpkin Patch enters the final stretch of sales, Giant Jack guesses and family fun. The patch has the widest variety and the widest pumpkin in town.



The Fuji-Higashis family donated this classic Radio Flyer wagon to help pumpkins get rolling out the patch's front door.



Where in the World Are We?



KCOM station manager Jeff Shaw takes a break while hiking at Duck Lake Pass near Mammoth, with Barney Lake in the background. He is shown enjoying the Post and the sun at 10,800 feet elevation.

Send your photos of the Post in the far corners of the world, or of other communities named Piedmont, to: WITWAW, 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610.